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162 officials transferred after CM's surprise inspection exposes lapses



NATION: Pg 5

PM says Phase-1 signals TMC's downfall



FILM: Pg 14

Alia calls 'Alpha' a 'fun film'

Major blow to AAP as Chadha, 6 other RS MPs quit party to 'merge' with BJP

AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal says the BJP has once again betrayed Punjabis

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: In what can be described as biggest move of his political career, Raghav Chadha, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) Rajya Sabha member quit the party on Friday along with six other party MPs from Rajya Sabha -- Ashok Mittal Sandeep Pathak, Harbhajan Singh, Rajendra Gupta, Vikram Sawhney and Swati Maliwal, saying all of them had merged with the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

Chadha left the party which had co-founded, asserting that the Arvind Kejriwal-led party had strayed from its principles, values and core morals. The move by the seven MPs caught everyone by surprise as their bombshell exits were unveiled at a hurriedly called press conference at Constitution Club, a stone's throw away from Parliament House complex. Chadha was flanked by fellow Rajya Sabha MPs Sandeep Pathak and Ashok Kumar Mittal,



Rajya Sabha MPs Raghav Chadha, Sandeep Pathak and Ashok Mittal meet BJP national president Nitin Nabin at the party headquarters, in New Delhi on Friday

Soon after AAP chief Kejriwal alleged that the BJP had betrayed the people of Punjab while state Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann termed the seven MPs "gaddar" (traitors). The BJP extended a

warm welcome to the MPs as party president Nitin Nabin offered them traditional sweets and bouquets. "Welcomed Raghav Chadha Ji, Sandeep Pathak Ji, and Ashok Mittal Ji to the BJP

family at the Party HQ today. Also, best wishes to Harbhajan Singh Ji, Swati Maliwal Ji, Vikram Sahney Ji, and Rajinder Gupta ji to work under the dynamic leadership of PM Narendra Modi

Continued on P4

TAKEAWAYS

- » Chadha says AAP "abandoned principles, values, core morals"
- » Says 7/10 RS MPs merged; invokes Tenth Schedule (2/3 rule)
- » Claims signed merger papers submitted to RS Chairman
- » Bhagwant Mann calls defectors "gaddar"
- » BJP welcomes MPs; Nitin Nabin greets them at HQ
- » Sandeep Pathak says party drifted from founding ideals
- » 6 MPs from Punjab; Swati Maliwal from Delhi

- » Only 3 RS MPs remain in AAP: Sanjay Singh, ND Gupta, Seechewal
- » Chadha removed as deputy RS leader on April 2; rift became public
- » ED raided Mittal-linked firms (April 15) amid tensions
- » Sanjay Singh seeks disqualification; calls it betrayal
- » AAP alleges BJP "Operation Lotus", use of ED/CBI pressure

HC rejects Khera's anticipatory bail plea over allegations against Assam CM's wife Riniki Sharma

MPOST BUREAU

GUWAHATI: The Gauhati High Court on Friday declined anticipatory bail to Congress leader Pawan Khera in a case linked to his allegations against Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma's wife, Riniki Bhuyan Sharma, regarding multiple passports and overseas assets.

The plea was rejected by a single bench of Justice Parthiv Jyoti Saikia, who delivered the order after reserving judgment earlier this week. Khera had approached the high court on Monday after the Supreme Court of India directed him to seek relief there.

The controversy stems from statements made by Khera during a press conference, where he alleged that Sharma possessed passports of several countries and had undisclosed financial interests abroad. Following these claims, Sharma filed criminal complaints at the Guwahati Crime Branch Police Station under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

In its order, the court noted that Khera had asserted that his allegations were backed by documents in his possession. However, the police maintained that those documents had already been found to be false. The judge observed that after the case was registered, the petitioner did not claim that the police had fabricated evidence against him.

Referring to the prosecution's submissions, the court said the argument

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The judge pointed out that Khera had not yet conclusively established his claims

Oppn parties move fresh notice in Rajya Sabha for removal of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, lists nine charges

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Opposition parties on Friday renewed their push against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar by submitting a fresh notice in the Rajya Sabha seeking his removal, according to sources familiar with the development.

The notice, backed by 73 Opposition Members of Parliament, was submitted to the Rajya Sabha Secretary General by Congress leader Jairam Ramesh and Trinamool Congress leader Sagarika Ghose. It calls for an address to the President of India to remove Kumar from office, citing what the Opposition describes



as "proved misbehaviour". Announcing the move on X, Ramesh said, "In the Rajya Sabha, 73 opposition MPs have just submitted a new notice of motion... urging the removal from office of the Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar." He added that

the demand is based on alleged misconduct linked to decisions and actions taken on and after March 15, 2026.

The notice invokes provisions under Article 324(5) read with Article 124(4) of the Constitution, along with Section 11(2) of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023, and the Judges (Inquiry) Act, 1968. According to Ramesh, the Opposition has outlined nine detailed charges that, he said, "cannot be denied or suppressed."

Among the central allegations is what the Opposition describes as a pattern of partisan enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct. The notice specifically refers to the

Election Commission's alleged failure to act on complaints regarding Prime Minister Narendra Modi's televised "address to the nation" on April 18, at a time when the Model Code of Conduct was in force in poll-bound states.

The document states that despite complaints from political parties and citizens, "as on the date of this notice, Gyanesh Kumar has issued no show-cause notice, no advisory, and no public response." It contrasts this with what it calls swift action on complaints filed by the Bharatiya Janata Party against Opposition leaders.

The notice also points to a post made by the Election Commission on April 8 on

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India, US make positive progress in trade talks; both sides to remain engaged

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India and the United States made what the government described as positive progress in three days of trade talks in Washington this week, with both sides agreeing to stay in touch to preserve the momentum as negotiations move ahead.

Around a dozen Indian officials were in the US capital from April 20 to 22 for discussions with American counterparts on finalising the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement, or BTA. The commerce ministry said the talks covered market access, non-tariff measures, techni-

Talks covered market access, non-tariff measures, technical barriers to trade, customs and trade facilitation, investment promotion, economic security alignment and digital trade

cal barriers to trade, customs and trade facilitation, investment promotion, economic security alignment and digital trade.

"The meetings were conducted in a constructive and positive spirit, with meaningful and forward-look-

ing discussions enabling progress on key matters. Both sides agreed to remain engaged to maintain this momentum as they move forward," the ministry said in a statement.

The latest round of talks comes as the tariff environment in the United States has shifted, prompting both sides to revisit the framework of the agreement, whose text was released on February 7. US Trade Representative Jamie-Son Greer has described India as a "tough nut to crack".

The broader trade backdrop has changed sharply in recent months. After the US Supreme Court ruled against sweeping

'NO ONE CAN DICTATE TO ADULTS'

Stop chasing couples, focus on crimes: HC to UP cops

MPOST BUREAU

PRAYAGRAJ: The Allahabad High Court has quashed a criminal case against a young married couple while sharply criticising the conduct of the Uttar Pradesh Police, calling out a growing pattern of interference in consensual adult relationships. In its April 21 order, a Division Bench of Justices JJ Munir and Tarun Saxena said the police in the state were increasingly "chasing couples" and "investigating marriages" instead of focusing on actual crimes.

The case came before the court through a petition filed by the couple seeking to quash an FIR lodged by the woman's father. He had alleged that his daughter, aged between 18 and



19 years, had been taken away in a car by the man and his brother after she went missing. The court, however, verified her age through her high school certificate and confirmed that she was a major.

It also took note of documents showing that the couple had married in 2025 according to Hindu rites in Uttarakhand. The records included a government-issued marriage certificate and photographs of the

CLOSER LOOK

- » Bench calls it a "disturbing trend" in police functioning
- » Court says adults free to choose partner and residence
- » Says Constitution bars one adult controlling another's personal choices
- » Police actions termed illegal, may amount to offences
- » Court says such FIRs unnecessarily burden judicial system

ceremony, along with a joint affidavit stating that they were living peacefully as husband and wife.

Quashing the FIR, the bench said, "No one has business to tell a major, where he or

she will stay, or with whom he or she will live, marry or spend his or her life." It added that the Constitution does not permit one adult, regardless of their relationship, to control another adult's personal choices.

In strong observations directed at the Uttar Pradesh Police, the court said, "We find a disturbing trend these days where the police are registering FIRs and chasing couples, virtually investigating marriages, instead of investigating crimes with which their hands are full." It further said such actions amounted to a disservice and could even constitute offences in certain situations.

The bench also pointed to the burden such cases place on the judiciary, noting that unnecessary

COOLING OFF



A flock of rosy pelicans flies inside their enclosure amid heat at Lucknow Zoo, on Friday

PTI

Ashok Lahiri to be Niti Aayog V-C, Gobardhan Das member

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Noted economist Ashok Lahiri and scientist Gobardhan Das, two illustrious names from West Bengal, have been chosen to become the Niti Aayog Vice-Chairman and Member, respectively, government sources said on Friday.

Lahiri is a former chief economic advisor to the government and a member of the 15th Finance Commission. He is a member of the current West Bengal assembly of BJP from Balurghat but has been kept out of the electoral contest this time. He has served as the 12th Chief Economic Adviser.

Lahiri will head the government's apex think tank as the chairpersonship is held by the Prime Minister. He will replace Suman Bery, who had taken leadership of Niti Aayog in May 2022.

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CITY

ABDUCTED MINOR RESCUED 2

NATION

BIHAR GOVT WINS TRUST VOTE 5

EDIT

CRACKS IN COMMAND 6

INTERNATIONAL

DEMOCRATS CRITICISE TRUMP 9

BUSINESS

FOREX STOCKS JUMP TO \$703.308 BN 10

SPORT

KOHLI LEADS RCB'S WIN 12



IGIA TO EXPAND INT’L CAPACITY TO 32 mn

T3 Pier C to open for international flights

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi airport’s annual international passenger handling capacity will increase to up to 32 million, with Pier C at Terminal 3 set to commence international operations from the first week of May.

The Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA) has three terminals -- T1, T2 and T3. Only T3 handles international flights, and the current capacity is around 20 million passengers per annum.

In a release on Friday, Delhi International Airport Ltd (DIAL) said Pier C at T3 would commence international operations from the first week of May. T3 has four piers -- Pier A and B for international operations, while C and D are for domestic operations. Pier C has now been converted for international operations.

Generally, a pier at an airport is a long and narrow structure or transfer facility from the main terminal building and allows passengers to use aerobridges to enter an aircraft.

“With the conversion of Pier C, Delhi Airport’s international passenger handling capacity will rise by around 50 per cent, translating to an additional 10 million passengers per annum (MPPA). This will take Terminal 3’s total interna-



“T3 has four piers -- Pier A & B for int’l operations, while C & D are for domestic operations. Pier C has now been converted for int’l operations”

tional capacity to 30-32 MPPA, positioning the airport well to serve growing international traffic in the years ahead,” airport operator DIAL said.

According to the release, India’s international air traffic is expected to grow at around 7 per cent in the medium term, and Delhi airport, handling the country’s largest share of international passengers, plays a pivotal role in enabling this growth.

‘Accused infamous for aggressive behaviour’

Murder of IRS officer’s daughter



NEW DELHI: As crime and forensic teams conduct scene recreation in the murder of an IRS officer’s daughter in southeast Delhi, investigations have revealed that the accused, Rahul Meena, was infamous for aggressive behaviour in his native village, police sources said.

According to a police source, the accused was taken to Palam railway station on Friday, where he visited first after committing the crime. He will also be taken to a hotel in Dwarka, where he stayed for some hours before being arrested.

Police said the accused was known for aggression in his native place in Rajasthan. “During the inquiry, we came to know that Meena and his father were known in their village for their aggressive behaviour. Our team is there. They are told that his father is an alcoholic and Meena is addicted to online games,” said a police source.

Meanwhile, sources said police will conduct a psychological analysis of the accused to evaluate his mental state and behavioural patterns, as he has exhibited psychopathic tendencies and has had a history of violent conduct.

“Police are now planning a detailed psychological assessment of the accused,” said a source.

He said Meena was addicted to online betting and card games such as “teen patti” and had lost over Rs 7 lakh in the last few months, which drove him to frequently borrow money to sustain the habit.

The accused Meena, earlier sacked from the victim’s home for financial misconduct, allegedly hid his dismissal from his family. During interrogation, he showed no remorse and said the murder “just happened” in a fit of rage, while also admitting financial motives. P11

Traffic ASI dragged on car for 100 metres after being hit, driver flees

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A traffic police assistant sub-inspector (ASI) was injured after a car driver allegedly hit him and dragged him for nearly 100 metres while he clung to the vehicle’s wipers in Delhi’s Shahdara, an official said on Friday.

The incident occurred on Tuesday near the GTB Hospital intersection, where ASI Vikas Kumar (48) was on duty along with a head constable. Kumar, posted in the Shahdara traffic circle, was deployed for vehicle checking during his shift from 3 pm to 11 pm.

According to police, a black car with tinted windows approached the inter-

He sustained multiple injuries but narrowly escaped being run over

section from the Gate No 7 side and jumped the red light at around 4:50 pm.

“The head constable first signalled the driver to stop, but the driver sped up. Kumar then attempted to intercept the vehicle and gestured for it to halt,” a senior police officer said.

Police said the driver briefly slowed down, but as soon as the ASI moved in front of the car, he accelerated again and rammed into him.

“The impact threw Kumar

onto the bonnet of the vehicle. In a desperate attempt to save his life, he held onto the car’s wipers as the car zig-zagged away at high speed,” the officer said. The driver did not stop and instead drove recklessly for nearly 100 metres in an apparent attempt to dislodge the officer.

Eventually, the wipers broke, causing Kumar to fall onto the road while the driver fled. He sustained multiple injuries but narrowly escaped being run over. He was immediately taken to GTB Hospital for treatment. His challan machine was damaged in the incident, police said. A case has been registered at GTB Enclave police station.

Man hurt in knife attack

NEW DELHI: A man identified as Nazeem was injured after being attacked with a knife by his friends following a quarrel in Krishna Nagar, east Delhi, police said. A PCR call was received on Thursday night, after which police found him shifted to Hedgewar Aarogya Sansthan Hospital and later referred to GTB Hospital.

He sustained stab injuries on his left upper abdomen and hand. A forensic team collected evidence from the spot. An FIR under Section 109 (attempt to murder) has been registered and investigation is underway. MPOST



A week-long anti-drug awareness campaign titled ‘Nasha – Not Cool’ was launched across Delhi on Friday, with schools holding pledge-taking drives to promote a drug-free lifestyle. Students, teachers and staff members collectively pledged to stay away from drugs and spread awareness about their harmful effects. Initiative aims to encourage youth participation in building a drug-free society through sustained awareness activities across institutions

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a proclaimed offender and an alleged close associate of the Kala Jathedi-Sampat Nehra gang, who had been absconding for nearly eight years in connection with an attempt to murder and armed robbery case, an official said on Friday.

The accused, identified as Ravi Malik alias Bhura (43), was apprehended from Rohini area following a targeted operation based on specific inputs, the officer said.

Malik was wanted in a case registered in 2012 under multiple sections of the erstwhile Indian Penal Code, including attempt to murder, robbery, and assault on public servants, along with provisions of the



Arms Act.

He was earlier arrested in the case but was granted bail and later declared a proclaimed offender in 2018 after he failed to appear before the trial court.

According to the police, a team received secret information about Malik’s movement near a school in Rohini on April 22. Subsequently, a raiding team laid a trap and apprehended him.

Police: His life took a criminal turn in ‘06 following a dispute over an alleged encroachment on his sister’s property

Police said Malik has studied up to Class 12 and initially ran a building material business after his family shifted to Rohini. However, his life took a criminal turn in 2006 following a dispute over an alleged encroachment on his sister’s property, during which he opened fire on rivals and was arrested.

“While in jail, he came in contact with gangster Sandeep

alias Kala Jathedi and subsequently became an active member of his gang. Between 2009 and 2011, Malik was involved in multiple serious offences, including murder, robbery, attempt to murder and offences under the Arms Act.

He was also allegedly involved in the murder of a man inside jail premises in 2011 along with other inmates,” the officer said.

He said Malik was declared a bad character of Samaipur Badli police station, and Delhi Police announced a Rs 50,000 reward for inputs leading to his arrest in 2012. Later, in 2020, Uttar Pradesh Police declared a Rs 1 lakh reward for his arrest.

Malik was arrested following an encounter in 2012 and remained in jail till 2017. However, after being released on

parole, he went into hiding and resumed criminal activities.

“In 2017, he was involved in a murder linked to a rival gang in Burari, and in 2018, he was again involved in a robbery case in Rani Bagh,” police said.

While evading the police, Malik teamed up with another criminal, Shiv Shakti Naydu, and was allegedly involved in a 2020 murder case in Meerut, in which one person was killed and another injured.

He also evaded capture during an encounter in Meerut, despite sustaining multiple bullet injuries.

To evade arrest, Malik frequently changed locations and operated from remote places, including Dehradun. Police said he is also addicted to narcotics, which further aggravated his criminal behaviour.

Cops nab key accused in Adarsh Nagar murder case

NEW DELHI: The Crime Branch of the Delhi Police has arrested a 20-year-old man in connection with the sensational murder of a woman in the Adarsh Nagar area, officials said. The accused, identified as Arbaaz Ali, a resident of Shalimar Village, was apprehended on April 23 following a targeted operation based on specific intelligence inputs provided to the Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF).

According to police, Ali had been absconding after his alleged involvement in a brutal knife attack earlier this month. He was wanted in an FIR registered under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Acting on intelligence, a Crime Branch team led by Inspector Vikas Pannu and supervised by ACP Kuldeep Singh laid a trap on Outer Ring Road between Mukundpur Puri and Burari. The accused was intercepted and arrested while allegedly attempting to flee the city. Investigators said that on April 19, Ali, along with co-accused Ritik and Kunal, allegedly attacked a couple—Rakhi and her husband Anshu—at Transport Centre Jhuggi in Azadpur. Rakhi later succumbed to her injuries during treatment, while her husband survived. MPOST

GGM extortion case: Yoga instructor apprehended after weeks on the run

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police Crime Branch has arrested a yoga instructor in a blackmail and extortion case linked to Gurugram, officials said. The accused, identified as Rakesh Sharma, was apprehended near the Patiala House Courts on April 23 after sustained surveillance based on specific intelligence inputs.

According to police, Sharma had extorted ₹3 lakh from the victim and later demanded an additional ₹15 lakh by threatening to circulate objectionable videos. He had been absconding for weeks and frequently changing locations to evade arrest.

The case was registered at



Palam Vihar Police Station on March 21 after the victim lodged a complaint. She alleged that she met Sharma during yoga classes in the COVID-19 period, where he gained her trust and later developed a personal relationship.

During this time, he allegedly recorded private moments without her

consent and used them for blackmail.

Police said the accused initially assured the victim that the content had been deleted after receiving money, but later sent the videos to her husband and renewed his extortion demand.

Investigators also revealed that Sharma’s wife was earlier caught by Gurugram Police while attempting to collect the extortion amount, though he managed to escape at that time. The accused has a prior criminal record, including involvement in a murder case in Uttar Pradesh.

He has been produced before a New Delhi court, and further investigation is underway.

Court acquits ex-AAP MLA in ‘midnight raid’ case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Friday acquitted former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) MLA Somnath Bharti in a 2014 case, in which he was accused of assaulting African women following an alleged midnight raid at Khirki Extension here.

Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Neha Mittal acquitting Bharti of the charge levelled against him in an FIR lodged at the Malviya Nagar police station, saying the witnesses’ statements were inadmissible as they failed to appear and depose before the court.

“Any unlawful assem-

Any unlawful assembly could not be proved... The prosecution failed to prove its case

bly could not be proved... The prosecution failed to prove its case,” the magistrate said, quoting the substantive portion of the verdict.

According to the chargesheet, on the intervening night of January 15-16, 2014, Bharti, the then law minister of Delhi, and 16 others reached Khirki Extension at Malviya Nagar. They assaulted Ugandan women living in rented accommodation there, accusing them of being

involved in illegal activities, including prostitution, the chargesheet had alleged.

An FIR was lodged on a court’s direction after a Ugandan woman filed a plea on January 18, 2014. She had sought the registration of a criminal case against unidentified persons in connection with the incident.

In 2018, a magisterial court framed charges against Bharti and others under Indian Penal Code (IPC) sections 147/149

(rioting), 354 (molestation), 354C (voyeurism), 342 (wrongful confinement), 506 (criminal intimidation), 143 (unlawful assembly), 509 (outraging a woman’s modesty), 153A (promoting enmity between two groups or religions), 323 (assault), 452 (house trespass), 427 (criminal trespass) and 186 (obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions).

The court rejected Bharti’s plea that he was a minister at the time and required government sanction for prosecution, stating the alleged assault on foreign women at midnight could not be considered part of his official duties.

Gunfire in Karol Bagh leaves man injured; 2 empty shells recovered

Attempted murder case registered; three rounds fired

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A man sustained a gunshot injury in central Delhi’s Karol Bagh early Friday, following which a case of attempt to murder has been registered, police said.

According to police, a medico-legal case (MLC) call was received from Lady Hardinge Medical College and Hospital at 3:55 am, saying a man identified as Rohit, a resident of Anand Parbat, had been admitted there with a gunshot wound.

The victim, who is currently under medical observation, has



shared details about the suspects involved in the firing, police said.

A forensic team recovered two empty cartridges and one live round from the crime

scene, indicating that three rounds were fired, the officer said. Police have registered a case of attempt to murder, and efforts are underway to identify and arrest the accused, he said.

162 officials transferred after CM's surprise inspection exposes lapses

Move is part of a broader effort to tighten governance and improve service delivery

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: An unannounced on-ground inspection by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has sparked a sweeping administrative overhaul in the Trade and Taxes (GST) Department that exposed serious lapses. Acting on the directions of Rekha Gupta, 162 officers and staff members have been transferred in one of the largest reshuffles in recent months, underscoring a zero-tolerance stance on corruption and negligence.

The action comes days after the Chief Minister's unannounced visit to the State GST office at ITO on April 8, where multiple officials were found absent and irregularities were flagged. Officials said the inspection revealed gaps in accountability, prompting immediate directives from the top. Following the inspection, the Chief Minister ordered strict enforcement of discipline across all ranks. She directed



CM Rekha Gupta PTI

“Ensuring transparency and accountability in administration remains our top priority”

the implementation of biometric attendance and issuance of show-cause notices to those found absent without valid reasons. Clear instructions were also given to ensure that pub-

TAKEAWAYS

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» Following the inspection, the Chief Minister Rekha Gupta ordered strict enforcement of discipline across all ranks

» She directed the implementation of biometric attendance and issuance of show-cause notices to those found absent without valid reasons

» Clear instructions were also given to ensure that public services are not disrupted under any circumstances

» A total of 162 personnel have been transferred, including three Assistant Commissioners. The reshuffle covers 58 Grade-I Section Officers, 22 Grade-II Assistant Section Officers, 74 Grade-III Senior Assistants, and 5 Grade-IV Junior Assistants. A significant number of those moved

had been posted in the same department or location for over three years.

Reaffirming her government's approach, the Chief Minister said, “Ensuring transparency and accountability in administration remains our top priority, and corruption or irregularities at any level will not be tolerated.” She further added, “Such surprise inspections will continue, and strict action will be taken against those found neglecting duties that affect public interest.”

Officials indicated that the move is part of a broader effort to tighten governance and improve service delivery. The government has made it clear that responsibility will be fixed directly on officers in case of any disruption in citizen services.

The large-scale transfers are being seen as a signal of stricter monitoring across departments, with more such inspections likely in the coming weeks.

City Briefs

MAN DIES AFTER SEX-ENHANCING DRUG OVERDOSE IN GGM: POLICE

GURUGRAM: A 29-year-old man, Rohit Lal, was found dead in his rented PG flat in Gurugram's Sector 53, allegedly after consuming an overdose of a sex-enhancing drug. He worked with the Quality Council of India in Delhi. Police recovered medicine and supplement wrappers from the room. The body has been sent for postmortem, and viscera samples have been sent to FSL. Further investigation is underway.

MAN JUMPS TO DEATH FROM 6TH FLOOR OF FARIDABAD BUILDING

FARIDABAD: A 33-year-old man, Shashank Shekhar Mishra, allegedly died after jumping from the sixth floor of a residential society in Faridabad's Sector 63, police said. He was reportedly undergoing treatment for mental health issues and was unemployed. The incident occurred after an argument with his mother. He was taken to hospital but died during treatment.

Gupta reviews Heatwave Action Plan, sets target of zero heat-related deaths by 2030

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: As temperatures surge across the capital, the Delhi government has intensified its heatwave response with a comprehensive preparedness strategy aimed at protecting residents from extreme weather conditions. Chairing a high-level review meeting, Rekha Gupta issued strict, time-bound directions to departments, signalling a coordinated push to minimise health risks and ensure public safety during the peak summer months.

Reviewing the Heat Wave Action Plan 2026 at the Secretariat, the Chief Minister said the government is on full alert and has set a long-term goal of eliminating heatwave-related deaths. “We have set a clear



target of bringing heatwave-related deaths down to zero by 2030,” she said.

Key measures include the establishment of special ‘cool rooms’ in hospitals to treat heat-stroke patients and ensuring adequate bed capacity for heat-related cases. All ambulances are being equipped to handle emergencies, while more than 339 health centres have been stocked with ORS, ice packs and essential supplies. Over 30

hospitals are already equipped with dedicated cooling facilities. Focusing on prevention, Gupta directed departments to launch awareness campaigns across the city. “Departments must ensure that people are aware of preventive steps and safety measures during extreme heat,” she said. Schools have been instructed to introduce a ‘water bell’ system to remind students to stay hydrated, with provisions to distribute ORS packets if required.

The government has also ordered the installation and smooth functioning of drinking water facilities at key public locations, including hospitals, schools, bus stands, construction sites and public offices. Water tankers, coolers and ATMs are being deployed, alongside shaded shelters for

both people and animals.

Highlighting rising temperatures, the Chief Minister noted that Delhi has experienced extreme heat in recent years. The administration is relying on the India Meteorological Department's colour-coded alert system for real-time monitoring and response.

Special attention is being given to vulnerable groups, particularly outdoor workers. Gupta directed that work hours be adjusted to avoid peak heat exposure and said, “Employers must ensure shaded rest areas, drinking water and ORS at worksites to protect workers.”

Officials said coordinated efforts led by the Delhi Disaster Management Authority are underway to ensure effective implementation across departments.

DPCC issues time-bound SOP to crack down upon noise violation

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Pollution Control Committee has introduced a new Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) to strengthen enforcement of noise pollution norms across the capital, mandating time-bound action on complaints, scientific monitoring and penalties for violations.

Effective immediately, the SOP requires all complaints—covering sources such as restaurants, bars and construction activity—to be formally recorded and addressed within a structured framework.

Noise monitoring must be conducted within three days, with the DPCC's Air Laboratory assessing both the source and background sound levels in line with the Noise Pollution (Regulation and Control) Rules, 2000, framed under the Environment

(Protection) Act, 1986. If violations are confirmed, inspection reports must be forwarded within seven days, and environmental compensation imposed on offenders.

The SOP also mandates coordination between Sub-Divisional Magistrates and police to seize equipment generating excessive noise, ensuring on-ground enforcement. It sets clear permissible limits—for instance, 55 dB during the day and 45 dB at night in residential areas—and prohibits loudspeakers between 10 pm and 6 am without permission.

Aligned with directions from the National Green Tribunal, the move aims to plug enforcement gaps through accountability, transparency and stricter, evidence-based regulation.

Youth Cong launches ‘Behtar Delhi’ campaign



NEW DELHI: The Indian Youth Congress on Friday launched its ‘Behtar Delhi’ campaign, aiming to highlight pressing urban challenges such as pollution, waste management and water scarcity in the national capital. The initiative, unveiled at a press conference, is intended to evolve into a nationwide movement focused on bringing urban issues to the centre of political discourse.

Launching the campaign, Ajay Maken said it seeks to address the everyday difficulties faced by city residents, noting that such concerns often receive inadequate political attention. He described the effort as a “comprehensive mass movement” that will involve direct engagement with citizens to gather feedback and develop practical solutions.

Youth Congress national president Uday Bhanu Chib said the campaign will focus on civic issues affecting daily life, including pollution, waterlogging and access to clean water. He added that the organisation will also advocate for legislation to support gig workers, with a conference planned in Delhi next month.

The campaign raises demands such as removal of garbage dumps, improved drainage, 24-hour potable water supply and enhanced school safety. Delhi Congress chief Devender Yadav said the move comes amid worsening civic conditions, including mounting waste and recurring flooding.

Student safety in focus as Delhi govt enforces heatwave measures

CM Rekha Gupta directs schools to follow heatwave norms, submit compliance reports by May 2

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With temperatures rising sharply in the national capital, the Delhi government has stepped up heatwave preparedness in schools, directing strict compliance with safety guidelines to protect students. Acting on the directions of Rekha Gupta, all schools have been asked to submit a detailed compliance report to the Directorate of Education by May 2, in line with the India Meteorological Department's Heat Wave Action guidelines.

Officials said the move is part of a broader effort to



ensure that children remain safe during extreme weather conditions. Schools have been instructed to implement all

necessary preventive measures, including ensuring the availability of safe drinking water on campus and appointing design-

ated nodal officers to monitor heat-related protocols. Authorities have also issued advisories for parents, urging them to send children to school in light cotton clothing to minimise discomfort and reduce the risk of heat-related illnesses.

Parents have been encouraged to stay connected through class WhatsApp groups and immediately report any health concerns or issues to school authorities.

Emphasising student safety, the Chief Minister said, “For us, every child is precious and every student's well-being is paramount.” The government has made it clear that no lapses will be tolerated in implementing the prescribed safety measures.

In addition, a direct communication channel has been opened for school-related concerns. “Any school-related concern may also be sent to me directly through DM,” she said, indicating a hands-on approach to monitoring the situation.

The directive comes amid intensifying heatwave conditions in Delhi, with authorities aiming to ensure that schools are fully equipped to handle the impact of extreme temperatures. Officials noted that timely compliance and strict monitoring will be key to safeguarding students in the coming weeks.

Delhi mulls spl task force to eradicate dengue

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is planning to set up a special task force, headed by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi commissioner, to strengthen action against dengue and other vector-borne diseases, officials said. The move follows a 2021 Delhi High Court directive urging stricter prevention, coordination and accountability measures.

The panel will monitor mosquito breeding hotspots, oversee fogging and sanitation drives, improve surveillance and ensure quick response to complaints.

FOCUS ON STRONGER GOVERNANCE

Vijender Gupta names heads of key Financial Committees for 2026–27

‘Financial Committees constitute the backbone of legislative accountability...’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Strengthening legislative oversight over public expenditure, the Delhi Legislative Assembly has announced the appointment of chairpersons for its three key Financial Committees for 2026–27. Vijender Gupta said the move reinforces the Assembly's commitment to transparency, fiscal discipline and institutional accountability.

According to the announcement, Ajay Mahawar has been appointed Chairman of the Committee on Public Accounts, Raj Kumar Bhatia will head the Committee on Government Undertakings, and Gajender Singh Yadav has been named Chairman of the Committee on Estimates. The members of these committees had already been notified ear-



“They will discharge their responsibilities with diligence, contribute to strengthening legislative scrutiny”

lier this month.

Highlighting the importance of these panels, the Speaker said, “Financial Committees constitute the backbone of legislative accountability, serving as the primary institutional mechanism through which the legislature exercises detailed and continuous scrutiny over public expenditure and administrative functioning.” He added that their effective functioning is essential “to ensure transparency and fis-

cal discipline” and to maintain the integrity of governance through informed legislative oversight.

The Committee on Public Accounts, under Ajay Mahawar, includes members such as Harish Khurana, Kuldeep Kumar, Sanjay Goyal, Sanjeev Jha, Satish Upadhyay, Shikha Roy, Surya Prakash Khatri and Virender Singh Kadian.

The Committee on Government Undertakings, chaired by Raj Kumar Bhatia, comprises

Aahir Deepak Chaudhary, Anil Jha, Zubair Ahmad, Jarnail Singh, Kuldeep Solanki, Raj Karan Khatri, Ravinder Singh Negi and Tilak Ram Gupta.

The Committee on Estimates, led by Gajender Singh Yadav, includes Karnail Singh, Neelam Pahawan, Poonam Sharma, Pravesh Ratn, Sahi Ram, Sandeep Sehrawat, Umang Bajaj and Veer Singh Dhinan.

Expressing confidence in the newly appointed chairpersons, the Speaker said they will discharge their responsibilities with diligence and contribute to strengthening legislative scrutiny. The committees play a crucial role in examining government spending and administrative performance, forming a key pillar of the Assembly's financial supervision framework.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A structured mechanism for battery lifecycle management will be actively explored under the electric mobility ecosystem, Transport Minister Pankaj Singh said on Friday.

The Delhi government held a stakeholders conference, inviting suggestions for its draft electric vehicle (EV) policy, where the companies also suggested the need to integrate the EV Policy with Delhi's Solar Policy, enhancing sustainability outcomes.

“We are working towards making Delhi the ‘EV Capital’ of the country. The Delhi EV Policy 2026, when implemented, will increase the number of electric vehicles as well as the supporting infrastructure ecosystem in the capital,” Singh said.

This transition will significantly reduce pollution and ensure a healthier and better quality of life for our citizens, he added.

“The consultation was designed to capture evidence-based recommendations from industry stakeholders to support the refinement and finalisation of the draft EV Policy 2026,” Singh said.

According to officials, the consultation brought together key stakeholders across the electric mobility ecosystem to deliberate on actionable feedback and recommendations for strengthening the policy framework.

“During the session, it was opined that the stakeholders have a consultation with Delhi Transco Limited (DTL) to facilitate the adoption of EVs and the installation of a comprehensive public and private charging network,” an official said.

The Draft Delhi EV Policy 2026, announced earlier this month, outlines a comprehensive roadmap to scale electric mobility across the national capital.

“Stakeholders highlighted the importance of residential

charging infrastructure, with a focus on involving Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs) to address parking constraints and ensure last-mile accessibility,” the government said in a statement. During the conference, the expansion of charging infrastructure across categories, including public, residential, commercial, and fleet segments, was discussed.

Delhi currently has around 9,000 charging points, with an additional 4,000-5,000 points under development, and a target to scale up to 32,000-36,000 charging points in the coming years.

The need for mapping existing infrastructure in coordination with the original manufacturer and operators was emphasised to ensure efficient deployment.

The conference included sessions on two-wheeler, three-wheeler and four-wheeler manufacturers, power distribution companies and other members of the electric vehicle ecosystem.

‘GOVT COMMITTED TO SUPPORTING EVERY CITIZEN IN DISTRESSS’

Govt to SC: 10 Indians died while fighting with Russian forces against Ukraine

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Ten Indians have died while fighting alongside Russian forces in the ongoing Russia-Ukraine war, the Centre told the Supreme Court on Friday.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi said the situation requires “tactful handling” as there may be immense difficulty in recovering mortal remains from the war zone.

The submissions about the unfortunate deaths of 10 Indians were made by Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, representing the Centre, before the bench that was hearing a plea seeking directions to the government to take steps to facilitate the safe repatriation of 26 Indians who have allegedly been detained in Russia and forced to fight the ongoing war. The petitioners have alleged

Highlights

- » The petitioners have alleged that their kin were lured to Russia under the pretext of lucrative job opportunities, only to have their passports confiscated and be coerced into combat
- » The ASG further said the MEA has faced logistical hurdles and a lack of cooperation from some families regarding the repatriation of mortal remains

that their kin were lured to Russia under the pretext of lucrative job opportunities, only to have their passports confiscated and be coerced into combat.

Of the 26 individuals specifically named in the petition, the ASG confirmed that 10 have died, one is imprisoned on criminal charges and one has chosen to remain in Russia voluntarily.

The Centre said while some individuals were misled by unscrupulous agents, many had entered into “volun-

tary contracts” with Russian entities.

The ASG further said the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) has faced logistical hurdles and a lack of cooperation from some families regarding the repatriation of mortal remains.

“The government is committed to supporting every citizen in distress,” she said.

“In one instance, we arranged for the return of mortal remains, but the family told us to keep them for three months as they were pursuing

legal action. There are complex human angles involved,” Bhati said.

The petitioners’ counsel refuted the government’s claim of “voluntary” service and said this is a clear case of human trafficking.

He said the victims were duped by agents and forced onto the frontline after their travel documents were seized.

“The MEA has not been forthcoming,” he said, adding, “Families have sent 120 representations over the last few months with no response. They have not even collected DNA samples for identification. It is not just inaction, they are not even in contact with us.”

He also urged the bench to view the video evidence sent by a victim, detailing his plight from the war zone.

The bench directed the MEA to file a comprehensive status report detailing the specific steps taken to ensure the

safety and return of the citizens.

Earlier, the bench took note of the plea and asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who was present in the court, to take instructions on the issue.

The petitioners’ counsel told the bench that these 26 individuals were Indian citizens stuck in Russia.

He claimed that they were compelled to take part in the ongoing war between Russia and Ukraine.

The plea has sought directions to the Centre to take immediate diplomatic and consular measures through the Indian embassy in Russia to ascertain the whereabouts, legal status and safety of the detained Indian citizens.

It has also sought directions to secure consular access to these individuals in accordance with the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations, 1963, and the applicable bilateral consular agreements.

Centre to launch Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyaan App 2.0

To boost monitoring of anti-drug campaign

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment is set to launch the upgraded Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyaan (NMBA) App 2.0 to strengthen monitoring and coordination under the National Action Plan for Drug Demand Reduction (NAPDDR).

The enhanced application has been designed as a centralised digital platform to facilitate real-time reporting, monitoring and coordination among stakeholders at the national, state, district and institutional levels, the ministry said in a statement on Friday.

The Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyaan (NMBA), launched on August 15, 2020 in 272 vulnerable districts, has since been expanded to cover all districts across the country, with the aim of spreading awareness on substance abuse.

According to the statement, more than 26 crore people

According to the statement, more than 26 crore people have been sensitised under the campaign so far through over 8.3 lakh activities conducted nationwide

have been sensitised under the campaign so far through over 8.3 lakh activities conducted nationwide. This includes over 9.5 crore youths, 6.47 crore women and more than 28,000 master volunteers.

The existing NMBA App, accessible to authorised users, enables states, districts, spiritual organisations and other stakeholders to upload and track campaign activities through a consolidated dashboard with near real-time visibility.

It also provides information,

education and communication (IEC) material and supports onboarding and management of volunteers, besides facilitating awareness activities and access to de-addiction and mental health helplines.

The upgraded NMBA App 2.0 will introduce several new features, including access for citizens to take e-pledges, view IEC content, access helpline support and locate de-addiction centres.

Grant-in-aid (GIAs) institutions will be onboarded with role-based access to enable real-time reporting and monitoring of activities at de-addiction facilities, the statement said.

The App will also provide real-time status of ‘Anudari’ (grants) for such institutions, ensuring transparency and improved tracking of fund utilisation.

A ‘nearest de-addiction centre’ feature will allow users to locate treatment facilities easily, while a feedback mechanism will enable the public to share inputs for further improvement.

From Page 1 Major blow

towards the goal of Viksit Bharat 2047,” Nabin said in a post on X shortly thereafter. Raghav Chadha’s exit left his former boss Kejriwal and the party in a big bind ahead of assembly elections in Punjab which are only a year away.

He announced that seven of AAP’s 10 Rajya Sabha MPs – two-thirds of the party’s Rajya Sabha strength --were merging with the BJP, invoking the constitutional provision under the Tenth Schedule that protects such a large group from disqualification. “As per the Constitution, two-thirds of the total MPs of a party can merge with another party,” Chadha said.

“They have already signed, and this morning we submitted all the required documentation, including signed letters and other formal paperwork, to the chairman of the Rajya Sabha,” Chadha said.

Pathak, who held the post of national general secretary in the AAP, also said the party had diverted from the principles on which it was founded.

Of the seven MPs, six come from Punjab, including Chadha, Pathak, Mittal, Rajinder Gupta, Vikram Sahni, and Harbhajan Singh, while Swati Maliwal is from Delhi.

The three Rajya Sabha MPs who still remain with the party are Sanjay Singh, ND Gupta and Balbir Singh Seechewal.

“The Aam Aadmi Party, which I nurtured with my blood and sweat and to which I gave 15 years of my youth, has now completely deviated from its principles, values, and core morals,” Chadha said while giving reason for the breakup.

It was on April 2 that the AAP had stripped Chadha of his post as the party’s deputy leader in the Rajya Sabha, replacing him with industrialist Ashok Kumar Mittal — who, in a surprise move, walked with Chadha into the BJP. The move had made the rift in the party public.

Chadha, 37, a chartered accountant with a history of family business, was the youngest MP in the country when he had stepped in the Upper House.

AAP leaders accused the safari party of launching “Operation Lotus” to break away party MPs and of conspiring to stop the Mann government’s good work in Punjab.

On April 15, the ED conducted raids at business entities linked to AAP Rajya Sabha MP Ashok Mittal in Punjab as part of a FEMA probe. Pathak, who was national general secretary, was feeling sidelined as his role was restricted to just the day-to-day affairs of the party, they said.

Maliwal alleged that Kejriwal shielded individuals involved in misconduct. In a post on X, Maliwal said she had chosen the path of national and public service in 2006 but was ultimately frustrated with the party.

“From the RTI movement and the Anna movement to the formation of the Aam Aadmi Party and my eight years of

dedicated service at the Delhi Commission for Women, I contributed with absolute honesty and devotion at every stage,” she said.

“With great sorrow today, I must say that the principles, values and resolve for honest politics with which we began this journey have been abandoned by Arvind Kejriwal ji and, at his behest, the entire Aam Aadmi Party,” she added.

Addressing a press conference, AAP leader Sanjay Singh slammed the breakaway MPs, saying the people of Punjab would never forgive their “betrayal”.

In a post on X, Singh said he would submit a letter to the Rajya Sabha Chairman, seeking the disqualification of Raghav Chadha, Ashok Mittal and Sandeep Pathak for joining the BJP as their action amounted to voluntarily relinquishing the membership of their original party under the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution.

AAP’s Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh called it a betrayal of Punjab, saying free electricity, excellent schools, healthcare, water supply and jobs delivered by Bhagwant Mann government had become intolerable for the BJP. He further said that ED and CBI pressure was being used to engineer defections, and that the people of Punjab would answer any conspiracy to halt the state’s progress.

Addressing a press conference, senior AAP leader said: “BJP, PM Modi and Amit Shah’s ‘Operation Lotus’.

Responding to Raghav Chadha’s remarks, the AAP Rajya Sabha MP said, “You join the party that brought three black laws against farmers and then claim you are fighting for honesty and truth. How can anyone accept such arguments? You talk of honesty after joining a party whose Union Minister’s son is linked to the killing of farmers, and a party filled with those involved in murder, loot, rape, crime, betrayal of farmers, and crime, betrayal of Punjab’s people. Will anyone believe such claims of change and revolution?”

Punjab Chief Minister Mann alleged that the BJP was trying to break the AAP.

“When they did not find anything against Bhagwant Mann, they tried to break the AAP,” he said on his return from a week-long visit to the Netherlands and Finland to attract investments to the state.

Addressing a press conference in Chandigarh, Mann stated, “The wise and brave people of Punjab will never forgive the traitors who have backstabbed them for their own vested interests. Punjabis have never forgotten acts of betrayal, and those who deceived them have vanished into political oblivion.”

Highlighting a systematic attempt to undermine Punjab, the chief minister said the BJP’s political strategy across the country has been to weaken regional forces. “The BJP only knows how to break other parties because it lacks credible leadership. They tried to break Mamata Banerjee’s party, divided Uddhav Thackeray’s party, and Sharad Pawar’s party met the same fate. Leaders like Naveen Patnaik, Dushyant Chautala and Nitish Kumar have

also been targeted through similar manoeuvres,” he said.

“After this defection, the party’s Political Affairs Committee (PAC) will decide the future course, including disciplinary action. Our legislative party remains united and committed to Punjab’s progress,” he said.

Fourteen years after it emerged from the anti-corruption movement with a promise to redraw India’s political map, the AAP is facing one of its toughest setbacks. Born in Delhi in November 2012 out of street protests and citizen anger against graft, the party quickly turned into a formidable political force, clinching victories in Delhi – first in 2013, then later in 2015 and 2020 – and later expanding its footprint to Punjab.

Iranian FM

engagement,” the Foreign Office said in a statement, without elaborating.

Dar underscored the importance of sustained dialogue and engagement to address outstanding issues to advance regional peace and stability at the earliest, it said.

Araghchi appreciated Pakistan’s consistent and constructive facilitation role in this regard, and both leaders agreed to remain in close contact, it added.

Iranian media reported that Araghchi also spoke with Army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir on Friday. However, there was no confirmation from the Pakistani side.

The first round of US-Iran talks held on April 11 and 12 failed to produce a breakthrough, prompting a flurry of diplomatic efforts by host Pakistan to cool tensions and revive hopes for another round of dialogue.

On Friday, Secretary of War Pete Hegseth repeated US President Donald Trump’s threat to destroy any Iranian fast boats that attempt to put mines in the water or disrupt passage through the Strait of Hormuz.

Separately, the US Central Command said that the US forces have directed 34 vessels to turn around or return to port since the start of the blockade against Iran.

“For the first time in decades, three aircraft carriers are operating in the Middle East at the same time. Accompanied by their carrier air wings, the USS Abraham Lincoln, USS Gerald R. Ford and USS George H.W. Bush include over 200 aircraft and 15,000 Sailors and Marines,” it said in a post on X.

On Tuesday, Trump had extended the two-week ceasefire with Iran indefinitely to give Tehran more time to prepare a unified proposal to end the war, just hours before the truce was set to expire.

This week, Pakistan stepped up diplomatic engagements to bring America and Iran to the negotiating table for the second round of talks.

Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi held an “important meeting” with US Charge d’Affaires Natalie Baker on Thursday during which they exchanged detailed views on the latest regional situation and discussed

diplomatic efforts related to the proposed second round of peace talks, the interior ministry said in a statement.

The meeting, the second between the two this week, took place amid uncertainty over the US-Iran talks, with Islamabad under tight security for the proposed engagement.

In a social media post, Trump on Thursday said that the US has total control over the Strait of Hormuz, and no ship can enter or leave without its approval. “It is ‘Sealed up Tight,’ until such time as Iran is able to make a DEAL,” he said.

Trump also claimed that Iran is having a “very hard time” figuring out who their leader is. “They just don’t know! The infighting is between the “Hardliners,” who have been losing BADLY on the battlefield, and the “Moderates,” who are not very moderate at all (but gaining respect!), is CRAZY!” he said in a separate post.

Responding to Trump’s comments, both Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian and Parliament Speaker Ghalibaf issued identical posts, saying there are no “hardliners” or “moderates” in Iran.

“We are all Iranians and revolutionaries. With iron-clad unity of nation and state and obedience to the Supreme Leader, we will make the aggressor regret. One God, one nation, one leader, one path; victory for Iran, dearer than life,” they said in separate posts on X, which were re-posted by Araghchi.

Earlier, Trump shared a post by a conservative commentator, calling for the assassination of Iranian officials who oppose diplomacy with the US.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei lashed out at Trump for sharing the post, saying the US, which once presented itself as a cradle of democracy, freedom, and human values, “now appears to become a promoter of terrorism, murder, and mass violence.”

“What should one call this, if not a profound moral failure?” he asked.

Oppn parties

social media platform X following a meeting with a delegation of Trinamool Congress leaders. The post claimed the Commission had given a “straight talk” to the party. Opposition MPs argue that this marked an unprecedented instance of a constitutional body publicly naming and criticising a recognised political party during an ongoing electoral process.

Further, the notice cites a claim by the TMC that Kumar told its delegation to “get lost” during a meeting with the full bench of the Commission. The Opposition has described such conduct as “unbecoming” of a constitutional authority.

Additional charges include an alleged administrative lapse involving the use of a BJP state unit’s seal on an official document in Kerala, as well as concerns over the handling of electoral roll revisions in West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh. The MPs allege that these revisions led to large-scale deletions of

voters based on questionable criteria, describing the situation as “mass disenfranchisement.”

The Opposition has also questioned the transfer and posting of bureaucrats in poll-bound states, claiming these actions exceeded the Election Commission’s constitutional mandate.

Signatories to the notice include MPs from the Congress, TMC, Samajwadi Party, DMK, Left parties, Shiv Sena (UBT), NCP (SP), RJD, IUML and other allied groups.

The fresh move comes shortly after similar notices submitted in both Houses of Parliament were rejected by presiding officers. Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla and Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan had ruled that the earlier allegations, even if assumed to be true, did not meet the high constitutional threshold of “misbehaviour” required for removal.

Opposition members have now urged the Rajya Sabha chairman to admit the new notice and set up a three-member inquiry committee to examine the charges. They have also called for Kumar to recuse himself from election-related duties while the inquiry is underway.

If the motion is admitted and subsequently passed by both Houses of Parliament with the required special majority, it could result in the removal of the Chief Election Commissioner.

Riniki Sharma

that the case could fall under Section 339 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which deals with possession of forged documents or electronic records, “seems to have force.” It further stated that the matter could not be viewed as a simple case of defamation without additional elements.

The order also drew a distinction between political criticism and personal allegations. While noting that Sharma is married to the chief minister, the court said she does not hold public office. “If the accusations had been directed at the chief minister, it might have remained political rhetoric. However, an individual not in public office has been brought into the controversy,” the court said.

The judge pointed out that Khera had not yet conclusively established his claims that Sharma held multiple foreign passports or had invested significant funds in a company in the United States.

The court also observed that there appeared to be sufficient material for a prima facie case under Section 339 and noted that Khera had been avoiding the investigation. It held that custodial interrogation would be necessary to determine the source of the documents, the involvement of others, and how the material was obtained.

At the same time, the court said there was nothing to indicate that the case had been initiated with the intention of humiliating the petitioner through arrest.

Concluding that Khera was not entitled to anticipatory bail, the court dismissed the application.

Khera was represented by a legal team led by senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, while Assam Advocate General Devajit Saikia opposed the plea.

Earlier, Khera had secured a seven-day transit anticipatory bail from the Telangana High Court. However, this relief was challenged by the Assam Police before the apex court, which stayed the transit bail and directed him to approach the Gauhati High Court.

India, US make positive

tariffs imposed by President Donald Trump on several countries, the Trump administration later imposed a 10 per cent tariff on all countries from February 24 for 150 days. The court had on February 20 ruled against Trump’s reciprocal tariffs, which were imposed under the 1977 International Emergency Economic Powers Act, or IEPPA.

Under the original framework, the US had agreed to bring tariffs on India down to 18 per cent from 50 per cent. It had also removed the 25 per cent tariffs on Indian goods linked to purchases of Russian oil and was to cut the remaining 25 per cent to 18 per cent under the pact.

India, for its part, proposed to eliminate or reduce tariffs on all US industrial goods and on a wide range of agricultural and food products. These included dried distillers’ grains, red sorghum for animal feed, tree nuts, fresh and processed fruit, soybean oil, wine and spirits, along with additional items. New Delhi also said it intended to buy \$500 billion worth of US energy products, aircraft and aircraft parts, precious metals, technology products and coking coal over the next five years.

Officials said the talks have taken on added significance because India had earlier negotiated the deal while enjoying a comparative advantage over rival economies. With all US trading partners now facing a uniform 10 per cent tariff, the arrangement will need to be recalibrated and redrafted.

“As the circumstances have changed, every country is engaging with the US to see what is going to be the nature of their trade agreements with America,” a government source said.

The US Trade Representative in March also launched two unilateral investigations involving several countries, including India. India has rejected the allegations raised in both probes under Section 301 of US trade law and has asked that they be terminated, saying the initiation notice failed to provide a cogent basis for the claims.

The trade relationship is also shifting in the wider context of India’s commerce with major partners. China overtook the US to become India’s largest trading partner in 2025-26. The US had held that position for four straight years until 2024-25.

Indian exports to the US rose 0.92 per cent to \$87.3 billion in the last fiscal year, while imports from the US climbed

15.95 per cent to \$52.9 billion. As a result, India’s trade surplus with the US narrowed to \$34.4 billion in 2025-26 from \$40.89 billion in 2024-25.

Ashok Lahiri

In addition, Gobardhan Das, also a Bengali, is set to become a new member of the policy.

These two names being picked for the post — formal appointments awaited — come at a time when the BJP is locked in a keen tussle with the ruling Trinamool Congress of Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee in Bengal. The second phase of the ongoing assembly elections in West Bengal will be held on April 29.

Lahiri, an alumnus of the economics department at Presidency University, Kolkata, has held research, teaching or leadership positions at the Delhi School of Economics, the Asian Development Bank, Bandhan Bank, and the National Institute of Public Finance and Policy.

He has also had stints with the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund as a consultant and senior economist, respectively.

Gobardhan Das is the director of the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research (IISER), Bhopal. Prior to assuming this position, he was working as a professor and chair of the Special Centre for Molecular Medicine at the Capital’s Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU). He is a former BJP member who unsuccessfully contested the 2021 West Bengal polls from the Purbasthali Uttar constituency.

HC to UP cops

FIRs were swelling court dockets. It said many such matters reach the courts only because of improper police action at the stage of registering cases.

Addressing the father’s complaint, the court said that if he was unable to locate his daughter, he could have filed a missing person report to trace her whereabouts. “There was no occasion to register a crime,” the bench observed, adding that the FIR was a serious intrusion into the couple’s personal liberty.

The court directed the Director General of Police, Uttar Pradesh, and the Additional Chief Secretary (Home) to take remedial steps to prevent such practices, warning that it may be compelled to intervene if corrective action is not taken.

It also ordered that an entry be made in the police station’s general diary recording that the FIR had been quashed. Additionally, the court issued a mandamus restraining the woman’s father and other respondents from entering the couple’s matrimonial home or disturbing their peaceful married life.

The ruling makes clear that while the directions are issued to the Uttar Pradesh Police, the principle remains that consenting adults are free to choose their partners without unlawful interference.

'Wave of change': PM says Phase-1 polling signals TMC's downfall

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EDITORIAL

CRACKS IN COMMAND

The sudden exit of seven Rajya Sabha members from the Aam Aadmi Party marks more than a moment of internal turbulence; it signals a structural rupture within a political formation that once prided itself on cohesion and ideological clarity. While defections are not uncommon in Indian politics, the scale and synchronisation of this departure—coming at a politically sensitive juncture—suggest that the crisis has moved beyond routine dissent. It reflects a deeper churn within the party, one that has been building over time and has now found expression in a dramatic and public unravelling. For a party that rose rapidly on the promise of being an alternative to entrenched political cultures, such a moment inevitably raises questions about whether it is now confronting the very contradictions it once sought to challenge.

The origins of this crisis can be traced to developments in 2024, when Swati Maliwal levelled serious allegations related to an incident at the residence of Arvind Kejriwal. Irrespective of the legal trajectory of that episode, its political impact was immediate and enduring. It marked a point at which internal discord became visible in the public domain, unsettling the party's carefully cultivated image of discipline and ethical governance. For a political organisation built on the plank of anti-corruption and accountability, even the perception of internal impropriety carries disproportionate weight. The inability to contain or conclusively address the fallout from that controversy appears to have contributed to a lingering atmosphere of mistrust, one that would later manifest in more visible fractures.

The marginalisation of Raghav Chadha further deepened these faultlines. Once seen as a key architect of the party's expansion beyond Delhi, particularly in Punjab, Chadha's rapid ascent had symbolised the emergence of a new generation of leadership within the party. His subsequent removal from significant organisational roles, culminating in his ouster as deputy leader in the Rajya Sabha, signalled a decisive shift in internal power equations. Such a trajectory—from prominence to peripheralisation—does not occur in isolation; it often reflects underlying tensions over authority, strategy, and the distribution of influence. Chadha's eventual role in the collective exit underscores how unresolved internal disagreements can coalesce into a coordinated political move.

The competing narratives surrounding the exodus further complicate the picture. On one hand, leaders such as Sanjay Singh have attributed the departures to external pressure, alleging the use of investigative agencies like the Enforcement Directorate and the CBI to engineer defections—a claim that resonates with broader opposition concerns about institutional overreach. On the other hand, departing figures, particularly Maliwal, have cited internal issues, including allegations of corruption, harassment, and the encouragement of questionable elements within the party structure. The convergence of these narratives—external coercion and internal dissatisfaction—suggests that the crisis cannot be reduced to a single cause. Instead, it reflects the interplay of political pressure and organisational strain, each amplifying the other.

What lends additional significance to this episode is the profile of those who have exited. These were not fringe voices but individuals who had, until recently, maintained a low profile and avoided public dissent. Their departure, therefore, indicates a cumulative build-up of grievances rather than an impulsive reaction to a single event. The fact that most of them represented Punjab in the Rajya Sabha also places a spotlight on the party's organisational stability in a state that has been central to its expansion strategy. Any erosion of cohesion in Punjab could have implications that extend beyond parliamentary arithmetic, potentially affecting the party's electoral positioning in upcoming contests.

At a broader level, this crisis highlights the inherent vulnerabilities of relatively young, centralised political formations. The Aam Aadmi Party, born out of a movement and shaped by a strong leadership core, has benefited from a unified command structure. However, such centralisation can also limit avenues for internal dialogue and dissent, leading to the accumulation of unresolved tensions. For a party whose political identity is closely tied to principles of transparency and accountability, internal discord of this nature poses a fundamental challenge. The coming months will test whether it can translate this moment of crisis into an opportunity for introspection and reform, or whether the current rupture will deepen into a more enduring fragmentation, reshaping its role in India's evolving political landscape.

GREEN THOUGHTS



SUDHEER KUMAR SHUKLA

THE WRITER IS HEAD-THINK TANK, MOBIUS FOUNDATION, NEW DELHI

The 2026 framework tightens compliance but sidesteps the structural drivers of plastic waste

Nearly a decade after the Plastic Waste Management (PWM) Rules, 2016 promised a systemic shift, plastic waste continues to overwhelm landfills, choke rivers, and infiltrate food chains. The newly notified Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2026, deepen compliance frameworks and digitise monitoring. Yet they leave untouched the central contradiction: a policy regime that manages waste more efficiently, but does little to reduce the production that creates it.

The PWM Rules, 2016 marked a significant departure by introducing Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR), shifting responsibility from municipalities to producers, importers and brand owners. Subsequent amendments in 2018, 2021 and the 2022 EPR Guidelines expanded this into a detailed compliance framework. The 2026 rules build on this trajectory with tighter targets, digital traceability and stricter reporting obligations.

On paper, the evolution appears robust. But outcomes tell a different story. India today generates millions of tonnes of plastic waste each year, with a substantial share remaining mismanaged—leaking into rivers, floodplains, and coastal ecosystems. According to official data from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), reported plastic waste generation stood at about 4.13 million tonnes in 2022–23, following a dip to 3.90 million tonnes in 2021–22 and a similar level of 4.13 million tonnes in 2020–21. However, industry and think-tank estimates paint a far starker picture, suggesting that India now generates roughly 9–10 million tonnes annually—equivalent to nearly 26,000 tonnes per day. This divergence reflects continued growth in consumption and packaging use, even in the wake of expanded Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) rules and the 2022 ban on most single-use plastics.

The structural gap between plastic production and waste management continues to widen. The OECD projects that global plastic waste volumes could nearly triple by 2060 if current trends persist, even as recycling rates stagnate around 9 per cent and mismanaged waste could rise to nearly 22 per cent. Scenario-based modelling studies also suggest that annual plastic consumption may reach 500–600 million tonnes by 2025, with only a small fraction effectively recycled or reused within a circular economy framework. The United Nations Environment Programme reports that 19–23 million tonnes of plastic enter



As waste volumes rise and recycling falters, the gap between production and management continues to widen

Globally, the challenge is even more stark. According to the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, only about 9 per cent of plastic waste is recycled, while roughly one-fifth is mismanaged and escapes into the environment. Recent global assessments further estimate that plastic leakage into aquatic ecosystems remains in the range of 11–23 million tonnes annually, depending on methodology and year.

The structural gap between plastic production and waste management continues to widen. The OECD projects that global plastic waste volumes could nearly triple by 2060 if current trends persist, even as recycling rates stagnate around 9 per cent and mismanaged waste could rise to nearly 22 per cent. Scenario-based modelling studies also suggest that annual plastic consumption may reach 500–600 million tonnes by 2025, with only a small fraction effectively recycled or reused within a circular economy framework. The United Nations Environment Programme reports that 19–23 million tonnes of plastic enter

aquatic ecosystems annually. Together, these trends highlight a core reality: waste management systems are failing to keep pace with plastic production.

EPR and the limits of recycling

The centrepiece of India's plastic policy—EPR—has been significantly strengthened under the 2026 rules. Targets are clearer, compliance mechanisms are more structured, and monitoring is increasingly digitised through centralised portals. Yet, implementation remains constrained.

In practice, producers often outsource obligations to intermediaries, creating a system where compliance is achieved through documentation rather than verified environmental outcomes. The emergence of EPR credit markets, while innovative, risks becoming detached from physical waste flows if not rigorously audited. More fundamentally, the policy continues to rely heavily on recycling as the primary solution. This assumption is problematic.

A significant share of India's plastic waste—particularly multi-layered plastics—is

non-recyclable or economically unviable to process. Even where recycling occurs, it often results in downcycling, producing lower-value materials that eventually re-enter the waste stream. The CPCB's own implementation reports point to gaps in processing capacity and uneven infrastructure across States, leading to continued dependence on landfilling and informal recovery systems. Global evidence reinforces this limitation.

Even in advanced economies, recycling captures only a fraction of total plastic waste. The rest is landfilled, incinerated or leaked into ecosystems. In this context, a recycling-centric strategy risks delaying pollution rather than preventing it. The missing shift: from waste to production

The most critical gap in the 2026 rules is their limited engagement with upstream drivers of plastic pollution. First, there are no meaningful constraints on virgin plastic production, despite clear evidence that reducing production is essential. Second, the absence of enforceable eco-design standards allows the continued

proliferation of non-recyclable packaging. Third, economic instruments—such as taxes on virgin resin or incentives for reuse systems—remain largely underdeveloped.

Equally significant is the marginalisation of the informal sector. India's recycling ecosystem is sustained by millions of waste workers, yet their integration into formal EPR systems remains partial. This weakens both efficiency and equity. Enforcement presents another structural challenge. State Pollution Control Boards, tasked with implementing the rules, face persistent capacity constraints. While digital platforms have improved reporting, they cannot substitute for physical verification. Recent enforcement drives—such as penalties issued for violations of plastic rules—highlight that compliance gaps remain widespread despite regulatory expansion. The result is a policy framework that is increasingly sophisticated but institutionally stretched.

Beyond compliance

The Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2026, represent an important step in refining India's regulatory architecture. But they also underscore the limits of a compliance-driven approach to a systemic problem. Addressing plastic pollution requires a shift from managing waste to preventing its creation. This means prioritising reduction over recycling, embedding circularity at the design stage, and aligning economic incentives with environmental outcomes. It also requires integrating informal systems, strengthening enforcement institutions, and moving beyond target-based compliance to measurable impact.

India's plastic challenge is no longer about the absence of rules. It is about the absence of transformation. Until that shift occurs, the country risks continuing on a path where plastic is not eliminated—but merely redistributed across land, water and air.

Views expressed are personal

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

Nearly 44 crore of India's 53.5 crore workforce is informal, leaving almost 90 per cent without stable income, job security or social protection

The Invisible Labour

Sudden policy changes and regulatory moves almost always affects the most unfortunate citizens among us

A couple of months ago, one of the maids in our residential colony, hailing from West Bengal, quipped when I asked her about the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) — “I’m not going back, *didi*. I may not even vote this year. What will they do? Send me to Bangladesh?” Last week, after failing to get train tickets, she hopped onto a bus to undertake an arduous three-day journey back home to cast her vote. Her usual cheerfulness was replaced with a kind of desperation that somehow, anyhow, she had to get back to vote or else there would be hell to pay. The pressure this time was different, and her hailing from the minority community, only complicated matters further. She could lose her subsidies and social capital if she didn't return to vote. This has been the story across the nation as domestic staff scurried back to their home states to vote. Was the SIR necessary? And how effective has it actually been in flushing out fake voters? Maybe we will know in due course; however, my argument here is larger. Whenever there are sweeping changes, sudden moves, regulatory rigmorale — it's always the common person who suffers the most.

If you're in Delhi, Gurgaon, or Bangalore, you will know that there is a manpower crunch or rather, a maid crisis. Everyone's maids and their families have rushed off to vote in the ongoing Bengal and Assam elections — a telling fact that hundreds of households in India's metros are fuelled by the labour of Bengali and Assamese domestic help. When demonetisation hit, again the plight of unprotected migrant workers came to the fore. And obviously, nothing prepared us for the harsh reality that unfolded in front of our eyes in 2020. When Covid-19 lockdowns struck, hundreds of migrant workers from Bihar, Jharkhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bengal, Odisha, Assam, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and so on, trudged in the unyielding heat, attempting to cover innumerable kilometres on foot — they had to get home. Now when LPG's skyrocketing prices are pinch-



They power our cities, yet remain outside our everyday concerns and priorities

ing households, the poorest among them are reverse migrating and leaving the city to seek momentary respite in their villages.

If it wasn't for our vanishing maids, many wouldn't even have noticed the hardships; most don't even now. The truth is that the gap between the haves and have-nots is widening so much that the most impoverished don't even come within our daily circle anymore. We, a fortunate few, reside in a bubble, but real India is outside — struggling, grappling, often neglected and forgotten. Worker protests across the nation — the most prominent being the recent ones in Noida — signal a growing discontent. Prices are high, jobs are few, and the ones who do get employed, are often contractual labour who are hired and fired at will. As per the Economic Survey (2021-22), 43.99 crore of the total 53.53 crore workforce belongs to the unorganised sector. Almost 90 per cent of the Indian workforce lives under a constant threat of being unemployed and economically unsafe. A closer look at the organised sector reveals that even there a vast majority of the workers are contractual, meaning that they have no job or health security. As per recent reports, a staggering 42 per cent of workers in

the organised manufacturing sector for instance, are contract labour — a never-before-seen 27-year high!

The agitating workers in Uttar Pradesh were protesting wage disparity compared to the 35 per cent hike in minimum wage given to their counterparts in Haryana. Increasing and persistent global outages such as the ongoing war in West Asia has made the cost of living even costlier. They demanded a reduction of 12-hour shifts to strict 8-hour days along with weekly offs and bonuses. The workers also demanded the establishment of sexual harassment committees. Demonstrations turned violent with incidents of arson and destruction of public property. Interestingly, domestic workers also joined rank with rallying factory workers, further strengthening the protests and pushing the state government to announce immediate wage hikes. We noticed because of the disruption that the ensuing violence created in our lives. Otherwise, we are perfectly fine going through life pretending that the masses that form the backbone of our labour force don't exist. But they do, and they are more than just votebanks. We are just not paying enough attention to them or safeguarding their needs.

Views expressed are personal



WHO SAID WHAT



Prashant Bhushan @pbbhushan1

What is the difference between the first set of people who left AAP, and the latest set of seven people who have left AAP to join the BJP? The first set of people left when Kejriwal compromised the principles on which the party was set up. The second set led by Raghav Chadha enjoyed all the perks of power, including being nominated to the Rajya Sabha. They have joined the BJP with pure opportunism bereft of any principles.



Raghav Chadha @raghav_chadha

Today, exercising the provisions of the Constitution of India, more than two-thirds of the AAP MPs in the Rajya Sabha have merged with the BJP. Seven MPs have signed the document, which was submitted to the Hon'ble Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. I, along with two other MPs, personally handed over the signed documents.

PUBLIC DOCTRINE



SHOBHA VJENDER
THE WRITER IS A MEMBER OF THE ADVISORY COMMITTEE, NATIONAL COMMISSION FOR WOMEN

Women's reservation was meant to reset India's political balance. Instead, its rollout is now tied to processes that remain incomplete, highlighting deeper governance challenges

Promise Put on Hold

Despite constitutional backing, women's reservation remains stalled by delayed Census and delimitation, raising urgent questions about representation, accountability and India's democratic priorities

In September 2023, when Parliament passed the Naari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, a landmark Constitutional Amendment guaranteeing 33 per cent reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies, crores of Indian women dared to dream. For the first time in the Republic's history, a law acknowledged what our Constitution had always promised but never delivered: that women, who constitute nearly half of India's population, deserve an equal and guaranteed voice in governing the nation.

Yet, as I write these words in April 2026, the promise of that law remains incomplete. The law has now formally come into force, but its actual implementation—the reservation of seats in Parliament and State Assemblies—remains dependent on two constitutional prerequisites: a fresh Census and a fresh round of delimitation. Until these are completed, the promise remains intact in law, but deferred in practice.

This is not a political statement; it is a constitutional reality that every Indian citizen must understand.



India must ensure that women's representation, democratic fairness and institutional reform move forward together

Prime Minister Modi's Vision: Fertile Ground for a Women-Led India

To his credit, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has consistently recognised the transformative potential of women's leadership. From Beti Bachao Beti Padhao to PM Ujjwala Yojana, from Jan Dhan accounts empowering women financially to Mudra loans enabling women entrepreneurs, the current government has built a strong foundation for women's participation in the country's economic and social life.

The Naari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam is the political crown of this vision. The Prime Minister's push for a new Census and delimitation exercise is not a technicality; it is a democratic imperative. He understands that the temple of democracy must have walls that are fair before we can decorate them with justice.

The debate, therefore, is not merely political; it is constitutional. India must ensure that women's representation, democratic fairness, and institutional reform move forward together.

What is Delimitation—and Why Does It Matter So Deeply?

Let us begin with a simple question: should one Member of Parliament represent 10 lakh citizens while another represents 35 lakh? Common sense says no. Constitutional justice says no. Yet that is precisely the reality in India today.

Delimitation is the process of redrawing the boundaries of Parliamentary and Assembly constituencies based on updated population data. It ensures that each elected representative serves a proportional number of citizens, and that every citizen's vote carries equal democratic weight.

While constituency boundaries were redrawn in the 2000s using 2001 Census data, the broader allocation of parliamentary seats among states has remained largely frozen under the framework linked to the 1971 Census. At that time, India's population was approximately 55 crore. Today, we are a nation of over 140 crore.

In over 50 years, our demographic reality has transformed dramatically. The same parliamentary seat that once represented around 10 lakh people may now represent 30–35 lakh. This is not just administrative neglect; it is a quiet erosion of the principle of "one person, one vote, one value."

Ask yourself: how can a single MP meaningfully serve 35 lakh constituents?

How can equal representation survive across constituencies of such vastly different sizes? The answer is: they cannot. And yet, we have allowed this to continue silently, without sufficient public debate or urgency.

The Census That Never Came—and the Governance Crisis It Created

To conduct delimitation, we first need accurate, updated population data—a Census.

India's Census is conducted every ten years. The last completed Census was in 2011. The 2021 Census was scheduled as a matter of constitutional routine, but the COVID-19 pandemic caused it to be postponed. As a result, we now lack verified, updated population figures on which to base delimitation.

This creates a constitutional chain: without a Census, there can be no delimitation. Without delimitation, the Women's Reservation Law cannot be fully implemented, because the law itself mandates that reserved seats be allocated only after a delimitation exercise.

The Modi Government has expressed clear intent to move this process forward. But to begin, the country needs a base year and updated population data. This is not merely a technical reform; it is a democratic necessity.

The Parliament Special Session: A Moment That Revealed Much

On April 18, 2026, the nation watched a Doordarshan broadcast that brought renewed public attention to the constitutional questions surrounding the implementation of the Naari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam.

During the Parliamentary Special Session, debates highlighted how deeply Census, delimitation, and women's reservation are interconnected. Several opposition parties, including the Indian National Congress, DMK, Trinamool Congress (TMC), and Samajwadi Party (SP), raised objections regarding the sequencing of implementation and related constitutional concerns.

Millions of Indian men and women watching these debates were left asking: if women's reservation is a constitutional necessity, how long can procedural delays continue to postpone it?

The current system of unequal constituency sizes benefits those who have learned to function within its distortions. Delimitation would equalise representation. A fresh Census would bring accountability. Women's reservation would open the doors of power more widely. Structural reform always challenges existing political comfort.

By delaying these reforms, the message sent to Indian women becomes

deeply troubling: wait longer. That message must change.

The Emotional Cost: What Delay Means for India's Women

Let us step away from the language of policy for a moment, and speak plainly as women, as citizens, as human beings.

A woman in India is never a "separate identity" in her family; she is the heartbeat of it. She wakes before sunrise, holds the household together, nurtures children, cares for elders, and often contributes economically as well. She is the invisible infrastructure of this nation. And yet, in the halls of power, where decisions are made about her health, education, safety, and future, she is largely absent.

That is not a natural state of affairs. That is the result of decades of structural exclusion—political, systemic, and deep-rooted. The Naari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam was a moment of reckoning. It said, officially and constitutionally: women belong in Parliament. Women belong at the table where India's future is decided.

Every day that implementation is delayed is a day that the message reads differently: women, wait. Women, prove yourselves further. Women, the system is not yet ready for you. That message is unacceptable.

What Every Indian Citizen Must Do Now

This issue is too important to be left only to politicians and policymakers.

The questions of Census, delimitation, and women's reservation must reach every college classroom, every village panchayat, and every household dining table. Students of law must understand the constitutional dimensions. Students of economics must grasp the governance implications. Citizens across professions must feel the weight of what is at stake.

Ask your local representatives: when will the Census happen? When will delimitation be completed? When will the Naari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam be fully implemented? Do not accept silence as an answer. Do not accept "soon" as a timeline. These are not favours being granted; they are constitutional obligations.

India has a date with its own promise—the year 2047. Prime Minister Modi has envisioned a Viksit Bharat by then: a developed, empowered, equitable India. That vision is hollow without women at its helm—not merely 33 per cent of Parliament, but eventually 50 per cent, reflecting their true share of this nation's soul.

The road to women-led democracy in India runs through a Census form and a delimitation map. Let us not let procedural delays become permanent excuses. The women of India have waited long enough.

Views expressed are personal

VOTE APPETITE



ASIF ULLAH KHAN
THE WRITER HAS WORKED IN SENIOR EDITORIAL POSITIONS FOR MANY RENOWNED INTERNATIONAL PUBLICATIONS

The evolving rhetoric around meat consumption reflects a calibrated shift—one that prioritises electoral context over previously asserted ideological positions

Meat over Manifesto!

Across election states, food politics has flipped from moral policing to cultural appeasement, exposing how ideology bends quickly before the demands of the ballot

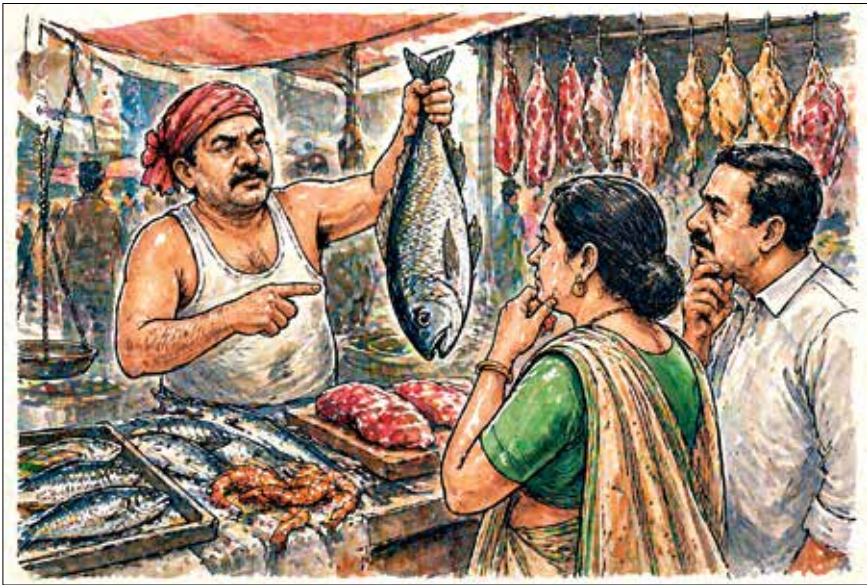
The meat of the matter is this: Assam and West Bengal assembly elections have acquired a new flavour—and it's decidedly non-vegetarian. From Assam to West Bengal to Bihar, food has moved from the dining table to the political centre stage. What we are witnessing is not just identity politics, but culinary politics—seasoned generously with contradiction.

In Bihar, the Prime Minister took a swipe at Tejashwi Yadav for eating fish during Sawan, framing it as an affront to religious sentiment—particularly on a Tuesday. He described this as reflecting a "Mughal mindset," suggesting it was intended to provoke and insult the religious sentiments of Hindus. Yet, shift the scene to West Bengal, and the tone changes dramatically. Senior Bharatiya Janata Party leader Anurag Thakur was seen openly eating fish on a Tuesday while defending the right of people to choose their food.

The symbolism doesn't stop there. In West Bengal, fish has not just been eaten—it has been brandished. Campaigns have featured leaders carrying fish during door-to-door outreach, signalling cultural alignment with Bengali identity. Even Prime Minister Modi, in his speeches, reassured voters that under a BJP government, there would be no shortage of fish in Bengal.

Travel further east to Assam, and the messaging becomes even more striking. Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma has openly invited people to visit the state and enjoy its cuisine "to their heart's content," including meat. The gluttony battle went from sublime to ridiculous when Sarma challenged West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee to a fish-eating contest, asserting he would eat "1 kg more" than her. He has also emphasised that people are free to consume beef within their homes—remarks that stand in stark contrast to the party's rhetoric in several northern states.

Consider Uttar Pradesh, governed by Yogi Adityanath, where meat shops have periodically



Across campaign platforms, food has emerged as a subtle yet significant theme

been shut during Hindu festivals and where debates around cow protection have been particularly intense.

The most striking aspect of this sudden non-vegetarian pugilism, however, is who is missing from the conversation. Muslims—who have often been at the centre of political debates around beef and cow protection—are now conspicuous by their absence. Since 2014, cow protection has frequently surfaced as a charged political issue, and incidents of so-called "cow vigilantism" have been widely documented, with many victims belonging to the Muslim community. Yet, in the current electoral narrative, the focus has shifted away from policing food habits to celebrating them—at least where it is electorally advantageous.

The political spark for this culinary pivot can

be traced to Mamata Banerjee, who framed the election as a defence of Bengali identity—warning that fish, a staple of the state, could come under threat if the BJP came to power. "People will not be able to eat fish, meat and eggs!" That single line appears to have forced a rapid recalibration.

The result is a remarkable spectacle: a party long associated with cow protection, vegetarian values, and restrictions around meat now positioning itself as a defender of dietary freedom—championing fish in Bengal, meat and beef in Assam, and choice wherever the electoral arithmetic demands it. Call it political expediency or flexibility, the truth is that the BJP, in exchange for votes, has put its core Hindutva ideology on the back burner. It seems the meat matters more—at least for the moment.

Views expressed are personal

Dear Editor

COMPLIANCE OVER INNOVATION

The Reserve Bank of India's decision to cancel the licence of Paytm Payments Bank marks a decisive assertion of regulatory authority in safeguarding depositor interests and financial stability. While the central bank has cited persistent non-compliance with licensing conditions and provisions of the Banking Regulation Act, the development raises concerns about governance standards within India's fintech-linked banking ecosystem. The fact that Paytm Payments Bank had been under scrutiny for several years, with restrictions imposed as early as 2022, indicates that the cancellation was not abrupt but the culmination of sustained supervisory concerns. In that sense, the RBI's action appears justified. However, it also underlines a troubling pattern—that repeated regulatory warnings may not always translate into timely corrective action by institutions. In a sector driven by rapid innovation and scale, compliance cannot remain an afterthought. The episode reinforces that financial inclusion and digital expansion must operate within robust regulatory discipline.

At a broader level, this development highlights structural gaps in how fintech-driven banking entities are governed and monitored. Payments banks were envisioned as instruments of inclusion, designed to serve the underbanked and integrate small users into the formal financial system. When such entities falter, it is not just a corporate failure but a potential erosion of public trust, particularly among vulnerable depositors. While the RBI has assured that Paytm Payments Bank holds adequate liquidity to repay depositors, the reputational impact cannot be overlooked. As India continues to lead in digital payments, it becomes imperative to strengthen oversight, ensure greater transparency, and enforce accountability earlier. The lesson is clear: technological innovation cannot substitute institutional integrity.

— NEERAJ PANWAR
Dehradun, Uttarakhand

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—CJI SAID HE WOULD FIX PLEA FOR EARLY HEARING—

Govt gets last chance for apprising its stand on deportation to B'desh

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday granted the last opportunity to the Centre to apprise about its stand on a plea seeking to bring back some people who were earlier deported to Bangladesh.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalaya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi asked the counsel for the Centre to take instruction and get back to it on the issue.

Senior advocates Kapil Sibal and Sanjay Hegde, appearing for Bhodu Sekh whose pregnant daughter was deported to Bangladesh, said it was a “bit unfair” on the part of the Centre which has not apprised the court about its views in the matter.

The CJI said he was granting one last opportunity to the Centre and the bench will proceed with the final hearing if the order is not complied with.

The CJI said he would fix the plea for an early hearing.

On December 3, last year, the top court allowed on “humanitarian grounds” the entry of a pregnant woman and her eight-year-old child into India, months after they were pushed into Bangladesh.

It had the West Bengal government to take care of the minor and directed the chief medical officer of Birbhum district to provide all possible medical assistance to the pregnant woman Sunali Khatun, including free of cost delivery.

It noted the submission of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, that the competent authority has agreed to allow the woman and her child into the country purely on humanitarian grounds without prejudice to rights and con-

Highlights

» The CJI said he was granting one last opportunity to the Centre and the bench will proceed with the final hearing if the order is not complied with

» On December 3, last year, SC allowed on ‘humanitarian grounds’ the entry of a pregnant woman and her eight-year-old child into India, months after they were pushed into Bangladesh

tentions, and they would be kept under surveillance.

The top court was hearing a plea of the Centre challenging the September 26, 2025 order of the Calcutta High Court by which it had set aside the central government’s decision to deport Khatun and others to Bangladesh and termed it as “illegal”

The bench had further said they would eventually be brought back to Delhi from where they were picked up and deported to Bangladesh.

Sibal, however, appearing for the woman’s father, had said it would be appropriate that she and her child be brought to their home district Birbhum in West Bengal, where her father resides.

The senior counsels urged the court that there were others also, including Khatun’s husband who are in Bangladesh, and need to be brought back to India for which Mehta may seek further instruction.

Mehta contended that he would be contesting their claim of being Indian citizens and maintained that they were

Bangladeshi nationals and it was only humanitarian grounds that the union government was allowing the woman and her child into India.

Justice Bagchi said if the woman establishes credentials that she is daughter of Bhodu Sheikh, then it would be sufficient to establish her Indian citizenship.

The woman’s father alleged that the families, working as daily wage earners in Sector 26 of the Rohini area in Delhi for over two decades, were picked up by police on June 18, last year on suspicion of being Bangladeshis and subsequently pushed across the border on June 27.

On September 26, last year, the high court quashed the Centre’s decision to deport Khatun and Sweeti Bibi, residents of Birbhum district in West Bengal, along with their families to Bangladesh after terming them as “illegal immigrants”.

The high court had directed the Centre to ensure that the six deported citizens are brought back to India within a month and rejected the government’s appeal to grant temporary stay on the order.

The high court had passed two orders in connection with a habeas corpus petition filed by Sheikh, who claimed his daughter along with her husband Danesh Sheikh and five-year-old son were detained in Delhi and pushed to Bangladesh.

Another petition from the same Birbhum neighbourhood by Amir Khan made a similar claim stating that his sister Sweeti Bibi and her two children were detained by Delhi police from the same area and pushed to the neighbouring country.

RGI orders village-wise mapping of vulnerable areas to ensure fair Census

A pan-India helpline number -- 1855 -- has also been launched for the Census

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Registrar General of India (RGI) has directed district magistrates and municipal commissioners to identify villages, habitations and communities vulnerable to “threats or intimidation” that could hamper the free conduct of the Census and ensure their coverage in the process.

Taking cognisance of the possibility that some areas could be left out of the Census due to inaccessibility or prevailing socio-economic realities, the RGI directed the authorities to do a vulnerability mapping of such areas.

It has asked officials to conduct the exercise revenue village-wise to “identify the villages/hamlets/habitats and segments of people vulnerable to any threat, intimidation or interference” with the free conduct of the Census.

Takeaways

» The Census Commissioner also asked district intelligence units to remain alert on the issue

» ‘The PCOs would thereafter make all necessary arrangements for conduct of 2nd phase



of the Census operations in all such special charges’

The RGI also directed that no houselisting or housing census will be conducted in the areas under the sole occupation and control of Defence Services formations, Central Reserve Police Units, Border Security Force and similar military or para-military organisations.

“The PCOs would thereafter make all necessary arrangements for conduct of 2nd phase of the Census operations (Population Enumeration) in all such special charges. It is to be

kept in mind that there shall be no Houselisting and Housing Census in such Special Charges,” it said.

A pan-India helpline number -- 1855 -- has also been launched for the Census.

RGI directed the authorities to identify the source of such threat or intimidation and the persons likely to spearhead such an offence of undue influence.

“While doing this exercise they shall take into account

UP pushes PNG adoption amid fear of LPG disruption

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The government has intensified efforts to promote piped natural gas for domestic use amid apprehensions of a potential LPG supply disruption linked to the ongoing Iran conflict.

Acting on a notification issued by the Petroleum Ministry on March 24, authorities have directed states to expedite the rollout of PNG connections, especially in areas where the pipeline network is already in place. The Food and Civil Supplies Department has issued fresh instructions to ensure compliance with the new policy.

As per the guidelines, households in notified areas will have to switch to PNG and surrender their existing LPG con-

nections. Officials have made it clear that consumers will not be allowed to retain both facilities simultaneously. A warning has also been issued that LPG supply may be discontinued after three months for those who do not shift to PNG.

The government has assured that there is no shortage of PNG and that adequate domestic stock is available. Supply is being maintained round the clock without any disruption, officials said.

Chief Secretary S P Goyal has directed departments to ensure strict implementation on the ground. In Uttar Pradesh, the expansion of pipeline infrastructure is underway at a rapid pace, with nearly 2,000 new PNG connections being provided every day.

Double-engine govt strengthening Panchayats for Viksit Bharat: CM Sai

RAIPUR: Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai on Friday said the “double-engine government” has been strengthening the Panchayati Raj institutions to reinforce the foundation of a ‘Viksit Bharat’.

He stressed that active participation of Panchayat representatives is key to rural development and ensuring the benefits of government schemes reach the last person.

Sai was addressing a conference of Panchayat representatives on the occasion of National Panchayati Raj Day at Pt Deendayal Upadhyay auditorium in Raipur.

“Development of villages depends on the proactive role of panchayat representatives. Only then can welfare schemes



effectively reach those at the grassroots,” he said, adding that under the leadership of Narendra Modi, a new chapter of holistic rural development is being written across the country.

The “double-engine government” (BJP rule at the Centre and in states) has been strengthening Panchayati Raj institutions to reinforce the foundation of a developed India, he said.

Sai said he began his politi-

cal career as a panchayat representative and had served as a panch and sarpanch, noting that grassroots governance provides valuable experience for leadership roles.

He added that many leaders have risen from panchayats to higher legislative bodies.

Highlighting the role of local bodies, he said Panchayats play a crucial part in making villages clean, healthy and developed, and effective policymaking depends on strong grassroots implementation.

The CM said schemes like Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana have ensured pucca houses for rural families, while the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana has significantly improved connectivity in villages.

MP0ST

Manipur: Three killed in twin firing incidents in Ukhrul district

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IMPHAL: Three persons were killed in two separate incidents of firing between armed groups of rival tribal communities in Manipur’s Ukhrul district on Friday morning, officials said.

In one incident near Mullam village, security forces recovered two bodies around 11.25 am, they said.

The deceased, identified as L Sithou and P Haolai, were found in camouflage outfits with bullet injuries, officials added.

Earlier, a heavy exchange of fire broke out between armed militants at Mullam village in the Tangkhul Naga-majority district around 5.30 am.

Some outlying houses in the village were also set on fire by the militants.

Meanwhile, the Kuki Organisation for Human Rights Trust condemned the killing of “two village volunteers” and the burning of houses at Mullam and Songphal villages.

The organisation demanded immediate registration of an FIR and a time-bound investigation into the incident.

In a separate incident, a 29-year-old man, identified as H Jamang from Chatric Khullen in Kamjong district, was killed on the spot in an ambush by armed militants near Sinakeithi village in Ukhrul district early Friday morning, officials said.

The body has been recovered, they added.

The Tangkhul Naga Long, the apex body of the Tangkhul Naga community, expressed “profound sadness” over Jamang’s killing.

In a statement, the organisation said, “Following constant movement and disruption along Sirarakhong and Sinakeithi (in Ukhrul district) by armed Kuki cadres, Naga village guards were posted near Sirarakhong and had gone out for patrol when they were ambushed by Kukis.”

‘Women are pillar of ‘Viksit Bharat’, Oppn creating obstacles in their progress’

MPOST BUREAU

PANCHKULA: When Prime Minister Narendra Modi envisioned a Viksit Bharat, he identified four pillars—the poor, farmers, women, and youth. If the wheel represented by women is not part of the vehicle of a Viksit Bharat, how will it move forward? The Opposition is trying to stop that wheel and create obstacles in its path. However, the country and its women have resolved not to let these attempts succeed.

These remarks were made by Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini while addressing the ‘Nari Samman Se Rashtira Uthaan’ programme organised by Vishva Parmarth Foundation in Panchkula as the chief guest. He said that such events are a significant effort to amplify the voice



of women’s rights.

The Chief Minister said that at the time of envisioning a developed India, PM Modi had stated that if 125 crore Indians each take one step forward, the nation will move ahead by 125 crore steps. Today, our population has reached 140 crore, out of which nearly half—70 crore—are women. Opposition parties are trying to stop this powerful segment from progressing. How-

ever, the entire nation knows that under the leadership of Narendra Modi, India has progressed in the past eleven and a half years at a pace unmatched even during the Congress’ 55 years in power.

He added that Narendra Modi took up the cause of women empowerment as soon as he became Prime Minister. When he launched the ‘Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao’ campaign from Haryana, the state had 871 girls for every 1,000 boys. Female foeticide was prevalent, and daughters were often seen as a burden. Recognising this social evil, the PM initiated the campaign from Haryana. ‘Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao’ is not just a slogan; it has given a new life to lakhs of daughters and restored faith in their value. As a result, Haryana now has 973 girls per 1,000 boys.

No court can force minor to carry pregnancy against her will, says SC

A bench of Justices BV Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan said the choice of the pregnant woman is relevant rather than that of the child to be born

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Observing that no court can force a woman, especially a minor, to carry a pregnancy against her will, the Supreme Court on Friday allowed a 15-year old girl to medically terminate her over seven-month pregnancy.

A bench of Justices BV Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan said the choice of the pregnant woman is relevant rather than that of the child to be born and stressed that continuation of such a pregnancy could have long lasting repercussions on the minor’s mental health, educational prospects, social standing and overall development.

The top court remarked that the reproductive autonomy of a woman must be accorded the highest importance and if a woman, carrying an unwanted pregnancy, is compelled to continue it then her constitutional rights would be breached.

“The right to make decisions concerning one’s body particu-

Key Points

» SC stressed that continuation of such a pregnancy could have long lasting repercussions on the minor’s overall

development

» Top court remarked that the reproductive autonomy of a woman must be accorded the highest importance

larly in matters of reproduction is an integral facet of personal liberty and privacy under Article 21 of the Constitution. The right cannot be rendered ineffective by imposing unreasonable restrictions especially in cases involving minors and unwanted pregnancies such as in the instant case.

“No court ought to compel any woman and more so a minor child to carry a pregnancy to full term against her express will. Such compulsion would not only disregard her decision autonomy but also inflict grave mental emotional and physical trauma in case she is compelled to give birth,” the bench said.

In the circumstances denying relief would compel the minor to endure irreversible consequences

and such an approach would be contrary to the constitutional and settled principles recognising reproductive choice is a fundamental right.

The apex court said the choice of the pregnant woman is relevant rather than that of the child to be born.

“It is easy to say that if the pregnant woman is not interested in raising the child she may give away the child in adoption and, therefore, she must give birth to the child.

“That cannot be a consideration particularly in cases where the child to be born is unwanted. In such a situation, directing the pregnant woman to give birth to the child against her wishes and, therefore, continue her preg-

nancy would negate the welfare of the pregnant woman and make it subordinate to the child yet to be born,” the bench said.

It said the constitutional courts must weigh the circumstances in which a case in relation to the welfare of the pregnant woman has to be considered rather than the child to be born.

“The constitutional Court ought to weigh all facts and circumstances from the lens of the party who intends to terminate the pregnancy and is willing to undertake the medical risks rather than directing completion of the pregnancy and giving birth to an unwanted child.

“If the constitutional Court states that even an unwanted pregnancy has to be continued then instead of approaching the court for permission parties then visit illegal abortion centres or secretly undergo termination of such a pregnancy which would make the pregnant woman more vulnerable and exposed to dangers,” the bench said.

Maha: 5 killed, 4 injured as speeding truck collides with car

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BHANDARA: Five people, including four women, were killed and four others sustained injuries after a speeding truck collided with a car carrying wedding guests in Maharashtra’s Bhandara district, police said on Friday.

The accident occurred around 9 pm on Thursday in Adyal village on a state highway in Pouni taluka, an official said. He said that the victims were returning from a wedding in Kondha when a speeding truck coming from the opposite direction crashed into their car.

Five people, including a couple and a mother-daughter duo, were killed, while four other occupants sustained injuries in the crash, the official said.

The police have arrested the truck driver, Durgesh Yadav (40), a native of Chhattisgarh, and a case has been registered against him under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 and the Motor Vehicles Act.

Noida unrest: UP govt moves to implement new labour codes

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: In the backdrop of recent unrest among industrial workers in Noida, the Uttar Pradesh government has fast-tracked the implementation of new labour codes aimed at providing relief to employees and streamlining workplace regulations.

Officials said draft rules for the four labour codes have been placed in the public domain for suggestions and objections from stakeholders.

The final notification is expected in May after reviewing feedback.

The new framework consolidates 29 existing labour laws into four codes: Code on Wages, 2019, Industrial Relations Code, 2020, Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020 and Social Security Code, 2020.

NABLUS IS WEST BANK'S SECOND LARGEST CITY

Palestinians mourn 3rd teenager killed in West Bank this week

TELL: Three Palestinian teenagers have been killed in the occupied West Bank this week in a spike of renewed violence, the latest shot dead by Israeli forces during a mid-week raid.

Palestinians in the northern West Bank village of Tell mourned the death of Youssef Shtayyeh on Friday after health officials said he was gunned down by Israeli forces in the nearby city of Nablus.

Waving Palestinian flags and carrying the 15-year-old's sheathed body down through the village streets, his relatives and neighbours moved in a tide of grief and recited religious verses in unison.

Israel's military acknowledged the fatality and said that its forces had fired after attempting to arrest a Palestinian who they said had hurled rocks toward them. They did not say why they were



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

operating in Nablus, the West Bank's second largest city, which is governed by the Palestinian Authority.

Shtayyeh is at least the fourth Palestinian killed by Israeli settlers or soldiers this week, following shootings across the

West Bank, in Hebron, al-Mughayyir and Deir Dibwan. Palestinians, rights groups and international observers

Highlights

- » Israel's military acknowledged the fatality
- » The forces did not say why they were operating in Nablus
- » Palestinians, rights groups and international observers are increasingly warning about the worsening violence

are increasingly warning about the worsening violence, where young Palestinian men are being killed with increasing regularity amid a broader climate of arson, vandalism and the displacement of farming communities near settlements and outposts in the occupied West Bank. AGENCIES

Democrats criticise Trump over 'racist trash' posts on social media

WASHINGTON: Democrat leaders slammed US President Donald Trump for referring to India and some other countries as "hellholes" and accused him of turning the presidency into a reality TV gig by amplifying "racist trash" on social media.

"Americans are struggling, and he's busy amplifying racist trash on social media, treating the presidency like a reality TV gig. This is a serious moment. Our country deserves leadership that acts like it," the House Foreign Affairs Committee Democrats said in a post on X.

The remarks came after Trump on Thursday kicked off a row by reposting comments by American radio show host Michael Savage that contained derogatory references to India. Savage had made the comments in the context of a case in the US Supreme Court challenging birthright citizenship.

Addressing Vice President JD Vance, Congressman Ro Khanna, in a social media post, asked, "Any comment on the President insulting immigrants from 'China or India or some other hellhole on the planet'."



US President Donald Trump

'Americans are struggling, and he's busy amplifying racist trash on social media platform'

Do you also think that India is a hellhole and Chinese or Indian immigrants denigrate America?"

Congressman Ami Bera said that as the son of immigrants from India, he takes great pride in both his heritage

and in the country that gave his family the opportunity to build a better life.

"The comments shared by President Trump are offensive, ignorant, and beneath the dignity of the office he holds. They reflect a fundamental misunderstanding of who we are as a nation.

America has always been strengthened by generations of immigrants who come here, work hard, and contribute to our country. They do not weaken America — they strengthen it," he said. AGENCIES

UK adds names of 33,000 Indian soldiers missing from WW I memorial

LONDON: The names of 33,000 Indian Army soldiers who died in the First World War but missing from a memorial in Iraq have finally been commemorated in digital form.

Iraq, then Mesopotamia, had been the scene of the British Empire's largest operations outside of Europe in the early 20th century.

The Commonwealth War Grave Commission (CWGC), a charity with a remit of commemorating all Commonwealth servicemen and women who died during the two World Wars, have introduced new digital name panels for the Basra Memorial in Iraq to ensure the missing names can be included.

Launched earlier this month, the digital memorial includes the names of Indian soldiers brought together for the first time alongside over 46,000 Commonwealth service personnel.

"The Mesopotamia Campaign



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

was one of the toughest campaigns in the First World War with Indian soldiers dying in the tens of thousands; yet their names were never added on the Basra memorial," said Shrabani Basu, CWGC Global Advisory Panel member.

"It is wonderful to see the new digital panels and to finally see the 33,000 Indian names displayed as they always should have been complete with ranks and regiments.

A historical wrong is being

righted.

Their sacrifice will never be forgotten," said Basu, the author of 'For King and Another Country: Indian Soldiers on the Western Front 1914-18'.

A digital option was chosen as an alternative until the site can be properly assessed and all the names can be properly commemorated.

"The launch of these panels marks an important moment for the Commission and the commemoration of the Indian Army's dead of the Mesopotamia Campaign," said Dr George Hay, CWGC Official Historian.

"For the first time, the names of these men will be displayed as they should have been nearly a century ago, restoring to them the honour they deserve. This takes us a step closer to fully reversing this historical inequality while also helping people around the world engage with these casualties and their stories," he said. AGENCIES

Congolese refugees return from Burundi

RUYIGI: Thousands of Congolese refugees in Burundi have returned to their homes across the border in eastern Congo following the withdrawal of Rwandan-backed rebels from a key town.

Some 470 people were in the latest batch to cross the border after fleeing violence in and around Uvira nearly four months ago. They sought shelter in the Busuma refugee camp in Buhumuza. AGENCIES

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS! EXAM SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

It is notified for the information of all concerned that following exam special trains will be run by Northern Railway on following dates to facilitate the candidates appearing in Uttar Pradesh Home Guard Exam-2026:-

04422/04421 Ghaziabad - Moradabad - Ghaziabad Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04422		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04421	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	04:00	Ghaziabad		22:40	---
07:00	---	Moradabad		---	18:00

Days of Run : 04422 Ex. Ghaziabad and 04421 Ex. Moradabad on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Pilkhuwa, Hapur, Simbholi, Garhmuktesar, Gajraula and Amroha stations.

04349/04350 Bareilly - Bijnor - Bareilly Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04349		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04350	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	03:35	Bareilly		23:35	---
08:00	---	Bijnor		---	18:00

Days of Run : 04349 Ex. Bareilly and 04350 Ex. Bijnor on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Milak, Rampur, Moradabad, Amroha, Gajraula, Mandi Dhanaura, Chandpur Siau and Haldaur stations.

04487/04488 Delhi Jn. - Shamli - Delhi Jn. Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04487		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04488	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	09:15	Delhi Jn.		16:00	---
11:40	---	Shamli		---	13:40

Days of Run : 04487 Ex. Delhi Jn. and 04488 Ex. Shamli on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Delhi Shahdara, Noli, Khehra, Bagpat Road, Baraut, Qasimpur Kheri and Kandhla stations.

04489/04490 Tilak Bridge - Saharanpur - Tilak Bridge Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04489		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04490	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	09:45	Tilak Bridge		18:00	---
13:40	---	Saharanpur		---	14:00

Days of Run : 04489 Ex. Tilak Bridge and 04490 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Anand Vihar (T), Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Naya Ghaziabad, Guldhar, Duhai, Muradnagar, Modinagar, Mohiuddinpur, Partapur, Meerut City, Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

04491/04492 Meerut City - Saharanpur - Meerut City Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04491		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04492	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	10:25	Meerut City		15:00	---
12:35	---	Saharanpur		---	12:50

Days of Run : 04491 Ex. Meerut City and 04492 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

04493/04494 Meerut City - Saharanpur - Meerut City Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04493		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04494	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	10:25	Meerut City		15:00	---
12:35	---	Saharanpur		---	12:50

Days of Run : 04493 Ex. Meerut City and 04494 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

04495/04496 Meerut City - Saharanpur - Meerut City Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04495		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04496	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	10:25	Meerut City		15:00	---
12:35	---	Saharanpur		---	12:50

Days of Run : 04495 Ex. Meerut City and 04496 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

04497/04498 Meerut City - Saharanpur - Meerut City Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04497		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04498	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	10:25	Meerut City		15:00	---
12:35	---	Saharanpur		---	12:50

Days of Run : 04497 Ex. Meerut City and 04498 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

04499/04500 Meerut City - Saharanpur - Meerut City Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04499		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04500	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	10:25	Meerut City		15:00	---
12:35	---	Saharanpur		---	12:50

Days of Run : 04499 Ex. Meerut City and 04500 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

04501/04502 Meerut City - Saharanpur - Meerut City Unreserved Special Train				06 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 04501		STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04502	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
---	10:25	Meerut City		15:00	---
12:35	---	Saharanpur		---	12:50

Days of Run : 04501 Ex. Meerut City and 04502 Ex. Saharanpur on 25.04.26, 26.04.26 & 27.04.26
Accommodation : General.
Stoppages : Meerut Cantt., Pabli Khas, Daurala, Sakhoti Tanda, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Jarauda Nara, Muzaffarnagar, Bamanheri, Rohana Kalan, Deoband, Talheri Buzurg, Nagal and Tapri stations.

Government of Jammu and Kashmir OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PMGSY DIVISION JAMMU. SHORT NOTICE INVITING e-TENDERS e-NIT No-EE/PMGSY/J/02 of 2026-27 Dated:-23.04.2026									
Executive Engineer PMGSY Division Jammu on behalf of The Government of Jammu & Kashmir UT, invites e-tenders on 'Scale Above/Excess (+) OR 'Scale Below/ Less (-) basis (i.e. on Percentage-Rate Basis) from approved and eligible Contractors registered with J&K State Govt. CPWD, Railways or equivalent and other State Govt up to 5.00 PM on 14-05-2026 for the following works:-									
Sl. No.	Name of Work/ Package No.	PIU	Cost of Decumment (Rs.)	Estimate Money (Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Call of tender	Time and date of opening of tenders	Class of contractor	Remarks
1	Restoration of 14 No. PMGSY Roads under the jurisdiction of PMGSY Division Jammu on Emergency basis i.e. (Motorable paths only) by way of clearance of slips likely to occur during Financial Year 2026-27 :- 1. T01-Gajraula to Chokkidi Package No. JK05-3009/Length = 4.500 Kms. 2. Main Road Bhawal to Jarnatia via Kodewala Package No. JK05-02/Length = 4.700 Kms. 3. Pargard to Bhawal Berth Package No. JK05-68/Length = 1.25 Kms. 4. Sangarpur to Geisinghwa Package No. JK05-78/Length = 1.550 Kms. 5. G057-Kalyanpur to Lalay Package No. JK05-14/Length = 4.725 Kms. 6. G043-Seri Bakhwala toJangar Package No. JK05-174/Length = 3.350 Kms. 7. G043-Sangarpur to Chinar Farm Package No. JK05-175/Length = 3.000 Kms. 8. G043-Sangarpur to Arit via Bhutan Package No. JK05-207/Length = 3.100 Kms. 9. G043-Sangarpur to Chinar Farm Package No. JK05-208/Length = 2.550 Kms. 10. Mahra Mandali to Gangwan Link Road to Sujapur Package No. JK05-01/Length = 3.05 Kms 11. Link road from Akalpur to Parniyal Package No. JK05-04/Length = 2.120 Kms. 12. Link road from Purnu Di Hatti to Gangwanvia Sujapur Package No. JK05-04/Length = 1.320 Kms 13. Midhivalela to Sakrin Package No. JK05-173/Length = 2.500 Kms. 14. T02-Bhawal to Pindi via Rajpora Package No. JK05-3009/Length = 4.825 Kms Total Length = 47' 150 Kms.	Jammu	2000	1000000	01 Day	1st	15-05.2026 at 02:00 pm	Any registered contractor with State UT CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works	
2	Restoration of 32 No. PMGSY Roads under the jurisdiction of PMGSY Division Jammu on Emergency basis i.e. (Motorable paths only) by way of clearance of slips likely to occur during Financial Year 2026-27 :- 1. Rabita to Porale Package No. JK05-86/Length = 5.900 Kms 2. Nandwal to Dharna Package No. JK05-91/Length = 5.900 Kms 3. Sangar to Gorda Package No. JK05-92/Length = 5.900 Kms 4. Parnoli to Goral Package No. JK05-133/Length = 4.125 Kms 5. Gorda to Jallor Package No. JK05-134/Length = 5.100 Kms 6. Parnoli to Jallor Package No. JK05-3012/Length = 17.000 Kms 7. Kotti Majara to Mathwar Package No. JK05-138/Length = 2.400 Kms 8. 1054-Nadval to Clay Package No. JK05-148/Length = 2.000 Kms 9. G032-Seri Parathan to Dhar Darochan Package No. JK05-149/Length = 5.900 Kms 10. 1058-Sulwan to Dhar Darochan Lower Package No. JK05-149/Length = 4.100 Kms 11. Kottan 18th JA Road to ChingariatLodhi Package No. JK05-202/Length = 5.600 Kms 12. Sangar to Shwarpota Package No. JK05-93/Length = 4.500 Kms 13. Nandwal to Chhota Package No. JK05-104/Length = 2.500 Kms 14. Jallor to Thakra to Khari Package No. JK05-105/Length = 4.00 Kms 15. 1029-Xm 178, JA Road to Nadval Package No. JK05-203/Length = 4.300 Kms 16. MR14-A to Rajpur Package No. JK05-3001/Length = 5.000 Kms Total Length = 83.275 Kms.	Jammu	2000	1000000	01 Day	1st	15-05.2026 at 02:00 pm	Any registered contractor with State UT CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works	
3	Restoration of 32 No. PMGSY Roads under the jurisdiction of PMGSY Division Jammu on Emergency basis i.e. (Motorable paths only) by way of clearance of slips likely to occur during Financial Year 2026-27 :- 1. Tachwan to Balha Package No. JK05-170/Length = 2.800 Kms 2. Kuffi to Gordan Package No. JK05-72/Length = 5.750 Kms 3. Tachwan to Baral Package No. JK05-209/Length = 5.100 Kms 4. Baral to Garad Package No. JK05-83/Length = 3.300 Kms 5. Chapat to Kottar Package No. JK05-103/Length = 5.100 Kms 6. MR08-Sapral to Parathal via Sangar Package No. JK05-3002/Length = 3.75 Kms 7. Sangar to Mera Japur Package No. JK05-35/Length = 13.165 Kms 8. G032-Ahmar Targwal via Charida Gran Package No. JK05-172/Length = 6.400 Kms 9. G072-Daharghar to Chargadon Package No. JK05-151/Length = 1.570 Kms 10. MR18-Sahal to Sangarpur via Banhal Package No. JK05-3008/Length = 5.200 Kms 11. Jarnatia to Pali via Bode Pal Package No. JK05-80/Length = 8.525 Kms 12. Sangar to Banthal Kalia Package No. JK05-102/Length = 10.000 Kms 13. T03 Km 9th to Mawa Brahmana Package No. JK05-130/Length = 14.000 Kms 14. T05 Km 7th to Kallwala Package No. JK05-169/Length = 5.100 Kms 15. T07-Kallwala to Patradu Package No. JK05-157/Length = 5.725 Kms 16. Ramnagar to Raju Chak Package No. JK05-71/Length = 6.600 Kms 17. Sehlor to Chamarkae Package No. JK05-200/Length = 1.500 Kms 18. Rajwal to Chamarkae Package No. JK05-77/Length = 2.850 Kms 19. Pindi to Deora Package No. JK05-84/Length = 2.500 Kms 20. G053-Sahal Badgal Road Package No. JK05-148/Length = 4.175 Kms 21. G0111 Muffki Kamran Link Road Package No. JK05-201/Length = 2.200 Kms 22. MR02-Maza Chak to Kargar Link Road via Bhawal Brahmana Package No. JK05-3007/Length = 6.190 Kms 23. Jallor to Mahad Package No. JK05-153/Length = 5.625 Kms 24. Bal Syleto to Sangarpur Package No. JK05-156/Length = 9.980 Kms 25. Other Major to Sandal Package No. JK05-82/Length = 2.850 Kms 26. Chavet Chaur to Ghar Mahan Package No. JK05-101/Length = 8.150 Kms 27. Tondia to Kargilan De Bhan Part1 Package No. JK05-150/Length = 3.00 Kms 28. Tondia to Kargilan De Bhan Part2 Package No. JK05-166/Length = 5.950 Kms 29. Thangan to Manng Di Partan Package No. JK05-81/Length = 3.225 Kms 30. MR17-National Highway Km 28th to Jallor Package No. JK05-3010/Length = 6.445 Kms 31. Pallenwala to Paltan via Dhar Khour Package No. JK05-88/Length = 3.500 Kms 32. Khour to Sarth Package No. JK05-177/Length = 5.750 Kms Total Length = 179.895 Kms.	Jammu	2000	1000000	01 Day	1st	15-05.2026 at 02:00 pm	Any registered contractor with State UT CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works	
4	Restoration of 10 No. PMGSY Roads under the jurisdiction of PMGSY Division Jammu on Emergency basis i.e. (Motorable paths only) by way of clearance of slips likely to occur during Financial Year 2026-27 :- 1. Dagar to Parvato Package No. JK05-62/Length = 7.150 Kms 2. Mahad to Baloda Package No. JK05-73/Length = 5.680 Kms 3. Jallor to Seor Package No. JK05-50/Length = 3.250 Kms 4. Seor to Kamthara Package No. JK05-75/Length = 5.100 Kms 5. Nagnay Syleto to Nelli Nallia Package No. JK05-152/Length = 18.00 Kms 6. T02 Km 1st to Bhargra Mahan Package No. JK05-3004/Length = 10.995 Kms 7. Chichro to Kharch via Lower Kalah Package No. JK05-3005/Length = 9.200 Kms 8. G039-Khour to Sarth Package No. JK05-177/Length = 5.750 Kms 9. D044-Dak Kharka to Chak Bhargava Package No. JK05-147/Length = 3.500 Kms 10. T02-Nall Beati to Badhwal via Khunda Package No. JK05-3003/Length = 5.375 Kms Total Length = 71.500 Kms.	Jammu	2000	1000000	01 Day	1st	15-05.2026 at 02:00 pm	Any registered contractor with State UT CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works	

‘Stable policy support essential to sustain pace of GDP expansion’

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman urged banks to focus on the physical contact with customers as they go global and digital

OUR CORRESPONDENT

PUNE: Domestic consumption is sustaining the growth momentum in the economy, and predictable policy support is essential to ensure that the pace of GDP expansion continues, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on Friday.

Speaking at an event organised by SBI here, Sitharaman also said that a committee of bankers is looking into the issue of whether to allow exclusive distribution tie-ups for selling third-party products by banks or adopt an open architecture approach.

She also urged banks to focus on the physical contact with customers as they go global and digital. The minister further said that the disinvestment process of IDBI Bank will continue going ahead.

“...consumption emerging out of its domestic market itself is able to sustain our growth, which is the fastest even now in the world,” she said. The finance minister said that while it is necessary for the consumption for the growth process to continue, it is also pertinent to have predictable policies.

“...unless our domestic manufacturing, agricultural growth,



Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, centre, unveils a commemorative postal stamp marking the inauguration of the new premises of the SBI Local Head Office, at Maharashtra Circle, in Kharadi, Pune district. SBI Chairman CS Setty, left, Secretary for the Department of Financial Services (DFS) M Nagaraju, second right & Chief Postmaster General Amitabh Singh, right, are also present

PTI

tourism, IT and related services sector are given that constant support, predictable support, India's growth story will be difficult to keep up,” she added.

Stating that exports are also important, Sitharaman appreciated the work of exporters in the last few months amid the setbacks like the US tariffs, wherein they have found newer markets while facing troubles from one.

Replying to a question on policy support to the affected sectors because of the current Middle East crisis, she said the government will see what it can best do and added that things

are very dynamic at present, with talks between the US and Iran being on.

She also reminded that the government has responded with a targeted package for the US tariff-impacted entities.

To a question on the asset quality impact at banks because of the Middle East crisis, Sitharaman suggested that there is no need to be concerned, as the non-performing assets are at a multi-decade low.

Answering a query on an open architecture approach when it comes to the sale of third parties' products by banks, she said a committee under the

Highlights

» The minister further said that the disinvestment process of IDBI Bank will continue going ahead

» “...consumption emerging out of its domestic market itself is able to sustain our growth, which is the fastest even now in the world,” she said.

» She also appreciated work of exporters in the last few months amid the setbacks like US tariffs

Indian Banks Association is looking into it.

“The IBA chairman with the IBA will be talking to banks to understand how best to go about it, what are the vulnerabilities by keeping one (entity), by keeping several...all these are going to be worked upon,” she said. The comments from the finance minister led to a sharp correction in the stock of SBI Life, which depends on its largest Indian bank parent for a bulk of its premiums.

Amid the huge changes in the tech landscape being brought about by Anthropic's AI model Mythos, the FM said

a meeting with banks was held in New Delhi on Thursday, and all the lenders have been asked to work together on it under the leadership of SBI chairman C S Setty, who also chairs IBA.

“In the coming weeks, there will be a lot of interaction within the banks, understanding where more investments will have to be made, what kind of technologies can come in, how AI itself can be used for countering this AI challenge,” Sitharaman said.

Meanwhile, Sitharaman said that LPG demand is being “largely” attended to by the companies, and everybody is getting the cooking gas, but there were a few instances of challenge.

Stressing the need for banks to have better connect with customers amid the progress on the digital front, Sitharaman said the human element is the spirit of inclusion in banking.

Banks need to ask themselves if they are getting distant from customers amid the accelerated digitalisation, he said.

She was speaking at an event where SBI inaugurated a new local head office, which will serve the bulk of Maharashtra except the Mumbai metropolitan area and the Konkan region, which will continue to be served by the LHO in Mumbai.

Markets sink for 3rd day on rising oil prices & selling in IT stocks

Rupee depreciates by 15 paise to 94.16 against US dollar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty tumbled over 1 per cent on Friday, falling for the third consecutive day, as a sharp rally in crude prices and massive selling in IT counters weighed heavily on investors' sentiment.

Unabated foreign fund outflows, a negative trend in global markets amid prolonged conflict and continued disruption in the Strait of Hormuz added to the gloom.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 999.79 points, or 1.29 per cent, to settle at 76,664.21. During the day, it plunged 1,260.13 points or 1.62 per cent to 76,403.87.

A total of 2,905 stocks declined, while 1,326 advanced and 158 remained unchanged on the BSE.

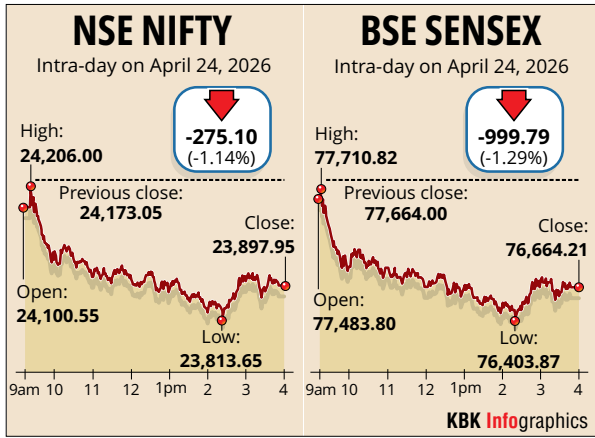
The wider gauge NSE Nifty slumped 275.10 points, or 1.14 per cent, to end at 23,897.95.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark tanked 1,829.33 points, or 2.33 per cent, and the Nifty dropped 455.6 points, or 1.87 per cent.

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed firms eroded by Rs 7,17,476.54 crore to Rs 4,61,49,758.18 crore (\$4.89 trillion) in three days.

From the Sensex constituents, Infosys dived 7.09 per cent after its revenue growth forecast for FY27 came in lower than market expectations.

HCL Tech, Tata Consul-



The mcap of BSE-listed firms eroded by Rs 7,17,476.54 crore to Rs 4,61,49,758.18 crore (\$4.89 trillion) in three days

tancy Services, Tech Mahindra, Sun Pharma, Asian Paints and ICICI Bank were also among the major laggards.

In contrast, Trent, Bajaj Finance, State Bank of India, HDFC Bank and Kotak Mahindra Bank were the winners.

The BSE SmallCap Select index dropped 0.95 per cent, and the MidCap Select index dipped 0.91 per cent.

All sectoral indices ended lower. The BSE IT tanked 5.13 per cent, BSE Focused IT (4.65

per cent), Healthcare (1.35 per cent), Telecommunication (1.33 per cent), Realty (1.30 per cent), Services (1.17 per cent) and Consumer Discretionary (1.04 per cent).

The rupee extended its losing streak for the fifth day in a row, depreciating 15 paise to close at 94.16 against the US dollar on Friday due to higher crude oil prices and strengthening American currency, with prospects of West Asia peace talks hanging in the balance.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, traded 2.17 per cent higher at \$107.3 per barrel.

FII's offloaded equities worth Rs 3,254.71 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the Sensex tumbled 852.49 points or 1.09 per cent to settle at 77,664. The Nifty dropped 205.05 points or 0.84 per cent to end at 24,173.05.

Govt misses FY26 highway construction target due to delay in land acquisition

NEW DELHI: National highway construction in the last fiscal year stood at 9,380 km, below the target of 10,000 km, a senior road transport and highways ministry official said on Friday.

The official said that the shortfall was mainly due to delays in land acquisition and securing other clearances.

Last fiscal year saw the shortest length of highway construction since 2017-18, when 9,829 km of highways were built.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways is primarily responsible for the development and maintenance of National Highways (NHs), including National



Expressways.

The ministry constructed 10,660 km of national highways in 2024-25, 12,349 km in 2023-24 and 10,331 km in 2022-23.

This slowdown is largely due to a sharp fall in the pace of awarding new highway projects.

The pace of awarding highway contracts fell from 12,376 km in 2022-23 to 7,538 km in FY25.

PTI

Barrier-free tolling on several NHs across country from Dec: Gadkari

NEW DELHI: Seamless, barrier-free tolling on several national highways across the country will be implemented by December, the Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari said on Friday.

Addressing the second edition of Logistics Shakti Summit & Awards 2026, Gadkari said India will have to develop good infrastructure to reduce logistics cost. “We plan to put up several seamless barrier-free tolling systems on several national highways across the country by December,” Gadkari said.

This new system facilitates barrier-free tolling using integrated technologies, including Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR) with AI analytics and RFID-based Electronic Toll Collection (FASTag). Under this, vehicles will be



charged based on their identification through high-performance ANPR cameras and FASTag readers, without needing to stop at toll plazas. In case of non-compliance, e-notices will be served to violators, non-payment of which may result in suspension of FASTag and other VAHAN-related penalties.

Gadkari noted that if India wants to become a global power, the country will have to reduce logistics cost to single digits.

He said a recent report prepared by IIT Chennai, IIT

Kanpur, and IIM Bangalore has revealed that India's construction of expressways and economic corridors has helped reduce the country's logistics cost to 10 per cent from 16 per cent earlier. Gadkari said logistics cost is 12 per cent in the US, 12 per cent in European countries and 8-10 per cent in China.

Referring to the West Asia crisis, Gadkari said India relies on imports to meet 87 per cent of its oil requirement. “We import fossil fuels worth Rs 22 lakh crore, which is also causing pollution... so we need to work on increasing production of alternative fuel and bio-fuel,” he said. Noting that green hydrogen is the fuel of the future, Gadkari said there is a need to reduce the cost of running a hydrogen fuel station to make it financially viable.

PTI

India's forex stocks jump \$2.362 bn to \$703.308 bn

MUMBAI: India's forex reserves jumped by \$2.362 billion to \$703.308 billion during the week ended April 17, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the forex kitty had increased by \$3.825 billion to \$700.946 billion.

The country's forex reserves had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year, before the onset of the West Asia conflict. The reserves witnessed a decline in the subsequent weeks due to the escalation of the West Asia conflict, which began around February 28, 2026.

The rising geopolitical uncertainty weighed on the Indian Rupee, prompting the RBI to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

For the week ended April 17, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased by \$1.481 billion to \$557.463 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

The value of gold reserves increased by \$790 million to \$122.133 billion during the reported week, the RBI said.

The Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) were up \$78 million to \$18.841 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was up by \$14 million to \$4.87 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the apex bank's data.

PTI

Gold declines by ₹200, silver tanks ₹3K on strengthening of US dollar

NEW DELHI: Precious metal prices extended losses for the third straight session in the national capital on Friday, with gold declining Rs 200 and silver plunging Rs 3,000 amid a firm US dollar and elevated global uncertainty.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity slipped Rs 200 to Rs 1,55,900 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes) from Thursday's closing level of Rs 1,56,100 per 10 grams.

Silver also dropped Rs 3,000 to Rs 2,47,000 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes). The metal had settled at Rs 2,50,000 per kg in the previous market session.

“Gold continued to face pressure, trading near a two-week low with a negative bias as ongoing geopolitical tensions in West Asia kept market sentiment cautious,” Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst - Commodities at HDFC Securities, said.

In the international markets, spot gold rose marginally to \$4,708.17 per ounce, while silver gained nearly 1 per cent to \$75.96 per ounce.

Price action continues to be driven by developments in West Asia, particularly tensions involving Iran, Israel, and the US presence in the Strait of Hormuz, which have kept uncertainty elevated, Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst - Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities, said.

PTI

IRCTC offers attractive 20% discount on its Buddhist Circuit Tourist Train Package

NEW DELHI: Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) continues to strengthen its position in experiential tourism with its acclaimed flagship product—the Buddhist Circuit Special Tourist Train.

The all-inclusive 7 Nights / 8 Days Buddhist Circuit Tour departs from Safdarjung Railway Station in New Delhi and takes passengers on a spiritually enriching journey through some of the most revered destinations associated with the life and teachings of Gautama Buddha.

The itinerary includes visits to Bodhi Gaya, Nalanda (via Rajgir), Varanasi (including Sar-

nath), Lumbini, Kushinagar, and Shravasti. The journey culminates with a visit to the iconic Taj Mahal, one of the Seven Wonders of the World, offering a blend of spiritual and cultural heritage.

The tour is conducted aboard a fully air-conditioned Deluxe Tourist Train featuring 12 state-of-the-art, ergonomically designed LHB coaches.

These modern coaches are equipped with enhanced safety features and passenger-friendly amenities to ensure a comfortable and memorable travel experience. Passengers can choose between AC First Class (AC-I) and AC Two Tier (AC-II) accommodations. The AC-I

coaches offer spacious cabins and coupes along with exclusive in-room amenities such as individual lockers, ensuring privacy and convenience.

The AC-II coaches have been specially redesigned to provide spacious cabins with separate seating areas, enhancing comfort for travelers.

Adding to the premium experience, the train houses two elegantly designed dining cars, each accommodating up to 64 passengers, allowing guests to dine together in a refined setting.

A fully equipped onboard kitchen serves a wide array of international and regional cuisines, catering to diverse culi-

nary preferences.

As part of a special promotional initiative, IRCTC is currently offering an attractive discount of 20 per cent on the package.

Under this limited-time offer, the tour is available at a starting price of Rs 76,905 per person on a twin-sharing basis, making this unique spiritual journey more accessible to travelers.

For bookings & further information, interested travelers can visit the official website www.irctcbuddhisttrain.com, contact the helpline numbers 8287930197 / 8287930031 or email at buddhisttrain@irctc.com.

MP05T

BoB launches ‘bob Senior Citizen Vishesh Samman’ Savings Account

MUMBAI: Bank of Baroda (BoB) has launched ‘bob Senior Citizen Vishesh Samman’, a premium savings account for customers aged 60 years and above, aimed at improving their financial and health well-being through a bundled offering of banking and lifestyle benefits.

The account provides healthcare and wellness services via Practo, including free online doctor consultations for up to six family members, up to 15 per cent concession on medicines and up to 20 per cent on diagnostic tests. Customers also get two complimentary doorstep banking services each month, enabling access to essential banking facilities



from home.

Lifestyle benefits include a complimentary bob Bhoomi RuPay Select Debit Card offering health check-ups, domestic and international airport lounge access, gym membership, spa and salon services, golf and OTT subscriptions. Banking benefits comprise a

50 per cent waiver on reverse mortgage loan processing charges, 20 per cent discount on locker rentals up to Rs 500, free NEFT and RTGS transactions, and a 50 per cent waiver on IMPS.

The premium account requires a monthly average balance of Rs 1 lakh.

MP05T

Ministry of Civil Aviation publishes April 2026 Flying Training Organisation rankings

Introduced through a directive from the DGCA, the framework establishes an evidence-based method to assess flight training organisations impartially

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA), under the leadership of Union Minister Ram Mohan Naidu, has released the second phase of rankings for DGCA-approved Flying Training Organisations (FTOs) for April 2026. With oversight from the minister shaping its structure, this round marks the second evaluation cycle designed to strengthen pilot education quality.

Safety benchmarks rise when institutions face transparent performance reviews conducted under federal super-

vision. Progress in aviation instruction follows systematic assessment rather than isolated effort. Public trust grows where consistency replaces variability in operational readiness.

Each rank reflects measured outcomes, not opinion, within a regulated national framework. Though quiet in tone, the move signals long-term commitment to structured improvement across training centres nationwide.

Introduced through a directive from the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), the framework establishes an evidence-based method to

assess flight training organisations impartially.

With oversight maintained over time, evaluations rely on consistent data inputs rather than subjective judgements. Released initially in October 2025, the opening set of results reflected early implementation outcomes across participating centres. Objectivity forms the core principle behind how institutions are now positioned within the sequence.

Speaking on the move, transparency in pilot training emerges through the new ranking framework, aiding future cadets and parents in

CLOSER LOOK

» Among recent evaluations, Avyanna Aviation Pvt. Ltd stands alone in Category ‘A’ – a shift from earlier results

» A larger count now fills Category ‘B’, suggesting refinements in operational quality across several FTOs

» Fewer organisations appear within Category ‘C’ this time around. Performance patterns point toward upward movement in training benchmarks

judgement. Growth potential within Indian aviation gains momentum due to initiatives promoting local air links alongside construction of travel facilities led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Fifty land-

ing zones may rise during the following half-decade, along with approximately five hundred flying units entering service. Almost thirty thousand flyers could be needed across the country in ten years' time

under current projections.

It is reported by MoCA that performance metrics have shown clear gains since the introduction of rankings. Flying time dedicated to training now stands at half, up from just above a third before. Fleet sizes across operators have grown noticeably under the new framework. Those pursuing a commercial pilot licence find their milestones reached more swiftly than in prior years.

Among recent evaluations, Avyanna Aviation Pvt. Ltd stands alone in Category ‘A’ – a shift from earlier results that showed none in the highest tier.

A larger count now fills Category ‘B’, suggesting refinements in operational quality across several FTOs. Fewer organisations appear within Category ‘C’ this time around. Performance patterns point toward upward movement in training benchmarks.

Notable movement emerged from Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Uran Akademi, advancing clearly ahead. Following behind, the Academy of Carver Aviation appears alongside FSTC Flying School within Category ‘B’. The National Flying Training Institute holds a position among them, while

Chimes Aviation Academy completes the group.

Should the plan move forward, it would reflect ongoing efforts to position India within international air transport networks. Emphasis shifts toward building stronger systems for preparing aviators locally. A framework called “Train in India, Fly in India” gains focus under this direction.

Goals extend beyond immediate upgrades – long-term positioning matters most here. Infrastructure development becomes central, though quietly so. Vision shapes policy, not the reverse.

Reliance Q4 profit declines 12.55% as energy crisis hits core O2C biz

Net profit of Rs 16,971 crore in Q4 FY26 was down from Rs 19,407 crore in same period a year earlier, according to a company statement

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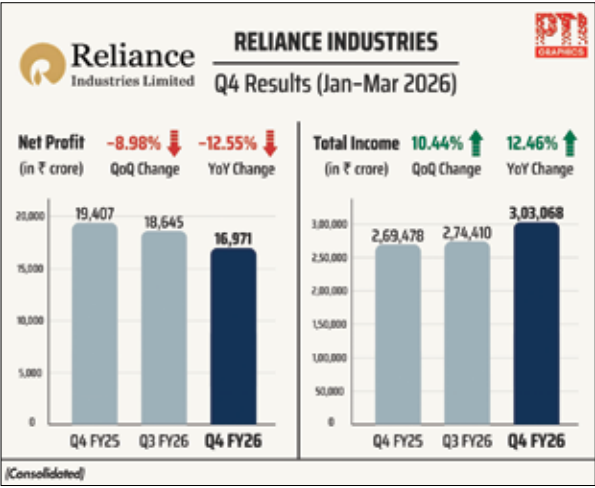
NEW DELHI: Reliance Industries Limited on Friday reported a 12.55 per cent decline in its March-quarter net profit, as the global energy crisis weighed on its core oil-to-chemicals business, offsetting gains in its consumer-facing telecom and retail segments.

Its net profit of Rs 16,971 crore in Q4 FY26 - was down from Rs 19,407 crore in the same period a year earlier, according to a company statement. The profit also declined sequentially from Rs 18,645 crore recorded in the October-December 2025 quarter.

The oil-to-chemicals (O2C) business, which contributes the lion's share of revenue to the country's most valuable company, was impacted by the war in West Asia, which triggered a sharp rise in crude oil prices and elevated freight, insurance, and fuel costs.

The government's reintroduction of a windfall tax on fuel exports further weighed on margins, while the company was compelled to divert valuable feedstock from petrochemical production towards manufacturing LPG to help manage domestic energy disruptions.

Profitability was also hit by a



Key Points

- » The profit also declined sequentially from Rs 18,645 crore recorded in October-December 2025 quarter
- » Jio Platforms, posted a 13 per cent rise in profit in Q4, as subscriber base swelled by 9.1 million to 524.4 million
- » In retail, profit rose to Rs 3,563 crore as it opened 333 new stores during the quarter

move from state-run fuel retailers to cap margins on petrol and diesel purchases from Reliance, as they sought to offset losses from a freeze in retail fuel prices. To remain competitive, Reliance similarly refrained from raising pump prices in line with the surge in crude oil costs, further pressuring margins.

The weakness in the oil-to-chemicals (O2C) business offset double-digit revenue growth in the telecom and retail segments. The telecom business saw earnings grow from a higher subscriber base, as well as increased per-user earnings, while the hyperlocal segment of retail saw

handsome order bookings.

The total income, however, rose to Rs 3.03 lakh crore in Q4, compared to Rs 2.69 lakh crore a year ago.

For the full financial year, the company posted a record net profit of Rs 80,775 crore, marking a 16 per cent increase from Rs 69,648 crore in FY25.

EBITDA came in at Rs 48,588 crore in Q4, almost the same as last year.

Depreciation was up 10 per cent at Rs 14,808 crore, largely on account of higher depreciation in digital services from network assets. Also, finance costs increased 7 per cent to Rs 6,585

crore, mainly due to operationalisation of 5G spectrum assets. For the full year, Reliance posted record high revenue of Rs 11.75 lakh crore and an all-time high EBITDA of Rs 2.07 lakh crore.

Its telecom and digital arm, Jio Platforms, posted a 13 per cent rise in profit in Q4, as subscriber base swelled by 9.1 million to 524.4 million and per user earnings rose 3.8 per cent to Rs 214 per month.

Its 5G subscriber base, at 268 million, accounts for about 55 per cent of the total wireless traffic. Jio added over 75 million 5G subscribers during FY26.

In retail, profit rose to Rs

3,563 crore as it opened 333 new stores during the quarter. JioMart hyper-local commerce average daily orders surged 29 per cent quarter-on-quarter and over 300 per cent year-on-year.

While O2C EBITDA fell 3.7 per cent to Rs 14,520 crore in Q4, Reliance's oil and gas production business posted an 18 per cent drop in pre-tax profit at Rs 4,195 crore on account of lower gas price realisation.

Commenting on the results, Mukesh D Ambani, Chairman and MD of Reliance, said the company navigated a challenging FY26 marked by geopolitical disruptions, volatile energy prices and shifting global trade dynamics. He noted that Reliance's diversified portfolio and strong domestic focus helped it withstand global headwinds even as India maintained its growth momentum.

Ambani highlighted strong performance in the digital and retail segments, with Jio continuing to expand across mobility, broadband and enterprise services, delivering robust EBITDA growth and progressing towards a potential listing.

Reliance Retail also recorded steady growth, supported by its omni-channel presence and rising traction in its FMCG business.

Reserve Bank cancels banking licence of Paytm Payments Bank

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The RBI on Friday announced the cancellation of banking licence issued to Paytm Payments Bank for non-compliance with norms, saying the affairs of the bank were conducted in a manner detrimental to the interest of its depositors.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) will make an application for winding up of the bank before the high court. The bank failed to comply with the conditions stipulated in the Payments Bank licence issued to it, the central bank said.

One97 Communications, which owns Paytm brand, in company filing said the company has no exposure to Paytm Payments Bank (PPBL) as it had already impaired its investment in the beleaguered entity as of March 31, 2024.

PPBL, was an associate firm of Vijay Shekhar Sharma-promoted fintech firm Paytm, came under the regulatory scanner on multiple occasions earlier, including in March 2022 when the central bank barred it from onboarding new customers.

The licence was cancelled effective from the close of business hours on Friday, the RBI said, adding that Paytm Payments Bank has enough liquidity to repay its entire deposit liability upon winding up.

The RBI said the affairs of the bank were conducted in a manner detrimental to its own interests as well as its depositors.

"The general character of the management of the bank is prejudicial to the interest of



The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) will make an application for winding up of the bank before the high court

depositors as also the public interest... no useful purpose or public interest would be served by allowing the bank to continue...", the RBI said in a statement. Paytm Payments Bank was not complying with certain norms of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949, it added.

According to the RBI, Paytm Payments Bank Ltd is prohibited from conducting the business of "banking" or any additional business specified under the Banking Regulation Act with immediate effect.

Paytm Payments Bank started operations as a payments bank with effect from May 23, 2017. The RBI had issued a licence to the bank to carry on the business of payments bank in the country.

The bank has been under the RBI lens over the past many years. Paytm in the regulatory filing cited disclosure

Highlights

- » The bank failed to comply with conditions stipulated in Payments Bank licence issued to it, the central bank said
- » One97 Communications, which owns Paytm brand, in company filing said the company has no exposure to Paytm Payments Bank (PPBL)
- » It had already impaired its investment in the beleaguered entity as of March 31, 2024

dated March 1, 2024 and said it does not have any exposure to PPBL or any material business arrangements with PPBL.

"No services provided by the Company are in partnership with PPBL. Additionally, PPBL operates independently, with no board or management involvement from the Company. There is no direct financial impact on the Company since, as previously disclosed, the Company had already impaired its investment in PPBL as of March 31, 2024," the filing said.

Paytm said its services will continue uninterrupted.

The services include the Paytm app, Paytm UPI, Paytm Gold and all other services offered by its subsidiaries and associated companies such as Paytm QR, Paytm Soundbox, Paytm card machines, and Paytm Payment Gateway, Paytm Money among others.

Adani Green Energy Q4 net profit jumps 34% to ₹514 cr

NEW DELHI: Adani Green Energy Ltd on Friday posted a more than 34 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 514 crore in the March quarter, driven by higher revenues from power supply business.

The company had posted a consolidated net profit of Rs 383 crore in the same period a year ago, as per a regulatory filing. The company's total income rose to Rs 3,727 crore during the quarter from Rs 3,278 crore a year ago.

For FY26, the consolidated net profit was at Rs 1,987 crore, down from Rs 2,001 crore in FY25. While total income was higher at Rs 13,819 crore from Rs 12,422 crore in FY25.

In a separate statement, the company said revenue from power supply rose 16 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to Rs 3,094 crore in the fourth quarter from Rs 2,666 crore in Q4 FY25.

On the annual basis as well, the revenue from power supply rose 22 per cent to Rs 11,602 crore from Rs 9,495 crore in 2024-25 financial year. Energy sales jumped 34 per cent y-o-y to 37,567 million units in FY26.

The company said that strong revenue and EBITDA growth are primarily backed by robust greenfield capacity addition of 5.1 GW in FY26, deployment of advanced RE technologies, strong plant performance and commissioning of new capacities in resource rich sites in Khavda, Gujarat and Rajasthan.

JioStar posts ₹36,248 cr revenue in FY26, crosses 515 mn viewers

NEW DELHI: Media and entertainment platform JioStar on Friday posted a gross revenue of Rs 9,784 crore and a profit after tax (PAT) of Rs 419 crore during the March quarter.

The annual gross revenue of JioStar — a joint venture created after the merger of the media business of Reliance and the India business of global media giant Walt Disney — for 2025-26 was at Rs 36,248 crore.

JioStar's "subscription revenue momentum was strong across digital & TV through the year", according to the earnings statement issued by RIL.

In 2026, digital ad revenue across sports and entertainment hit a record high, driven by CTV & focused content monetisation. However, TV entertainment ad revenue remained under pressure, due to contin-

ued spending cuts by FMCG.

In the March quarter, JioStar's revenue from operations was at Rs 8,372 crore. Its pre-tax profit (EBITDA) was at Rs 827 crore with an industry-leading margin of 28.1 per cent.

Its EBITDA for 2025-26 was at Rs 4,885 crore, which according to RIL was "industry leading annual EBITDA margin despite challenging macro environment". The "growth is driven by a stacked sports lineup and record engagement across marquee entertainment franchises".

The JV, which owns most of the marquee cricket broadcasting rights, had averaged 500 million monthly active users (MAUs) during the quarter, with the T20 Men's Cricket WC Final achieving a record 72.5 million peak concurrency, which is "the highest-ever for

any property and a global record". Moreover, in the current season of IPL, it is having a "15 per cent growth in digital reach over IPL 25 and 27 per cent growth in CTV Reach over IPL 25".

TATA IPL 2026 opened at a record scale with deeper engagement across platforms, reaching over 515 million viewers on linear TV and digital during the opening weekend, it said.

During the quarter, network continued to retain leadership in key markets with TV entertainment viewership share at 34.2 per cent share, reaching over 810 million viewers pan-India, it said. "Linear TV share in FY26 grew 0.8 per cent year-on-year to 34.7 per cent, which is close to the next 3 networks combined," it said.

Centre forms panel under SBI chief C S Setty to assess risks emanating from Mythos: FM

PUNE: Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday said the government has formed a panel under SBI Chairman C S Setty, who also leads the industry grouping IBA, to assess risks emanating from AI platform Mythos and come up with mitigating measures.

There will be a lot of interaction among banks over the next few weeks to understand the threats and also look at the areas where additional investments will be required, Sitharaman said on the sidelines of an event to inaugurate SBI's newly created local head office here.

"In the coming weeks, there will be a lot of interaction within the banks, understanding where more investments will have to be made, what kind of technologies can come in, how AI itself can be used for countering

Regulators across Asia, Europe & the US have already warned banks to review their defences and preparedness

this AI born challenge," Sitharaman said. The government had held a high-level meeting with banks on Thursday, that was also attended by IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw, Sitharaman, and other top officials.

Sitharaman said not much is known about Mythos yet and there are very few people who have tried the system, which is speculated to bring about radical changes in computing.

She said all this while, the system has been able to protect customers but the same record may not be sufficient to guard against newer platforms. The Meity is speaking with various governments and also technology companies to understand the issue, the FM said.

Anthropic's AI model Mythos has raised a global debate over vulnerability in the financial system as the model has the capability to find weaknesses in their operating system and launch a potential cyber attack.

Mythos' advanced coding capabilities give it an unprecedented potential to detect cybersecurity weaknesses and develop methods to exploit them, sparking concerns that it could be used to disrupt banking systems.

Regulators across Asia, Europe, and the US have already warned banks to review their defences and preparedness.

Mythos has raised alarm bells among regulators, who see it as a significant challenge to the banking sector and its legacy technology systems.

Banks and financial institutions are most vulnerable as there is high interconnected (payments, markets, clearing systems) and dependence on legacy IT systems operating in real-time.

One successful cyberattack can cascade quickly across institutions and markets as one bank is linked to many domestic and global institution for inward and outward payment, forex trading, money market exposure, stock market linkage, depositories and payment gateway, etc. PFI

HZL posts record ₹5,033 cr profit in Q4 FY26

NEW DELHI: Vedanta group firm Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) on Friday reported a record profit of Rs 5,033 crore for March quarter FY26 on the back of higher zinc and silver prices and increased production.

The profit was about 68 per cent higher from Rs 3,003 crore in the year-ago January-March period. The record quarterly profit was driven by an all-time high quarterly EBITDA of Rs 7,747 crore, up 61 per cent YoY.

The company also marked the historic full year (FY26) net profit of Rs 13,832 crore, up 34 per cent YoY.

Revenue during March quarter stood at Rs 13,544 crore, up 49 per cent YoY driven by higher zinc and silver prices, increased production, lead concentrate sale, higher



by-product realisation, and a stronger dollar. Income rose to Rs 13,824 crore over Rs 9,314 crore a year earlier.

The company crossed a key milestone of 1.1 million tonnes of mined metal production, as per a BSE filing.

"We also delivered a record quarterly refined metal production at the lowest cost of production of 903 dollar per tonne despite the ongoing geopolitical challenges. As we step into our 2.0 growth phase, we are strengthening our strate-

gic roadmap. With our move into critical minerals, we are aligning with future-facing sectors while contributing meaningfully to India's growth and long-term stakeholder value," Chief Executive Officer Arun Misra said.

Total expenses in March quarter rose to Rs 7,073 crore over Rs 5,532 crore in the year-ago period.

Chief Financial Officer Sandeep Modi said, "We have marked the historic full year net profit of Rs 13,832 crore, up 34 per cent YoY, backed by disciplined capital allocation and strong free cash flow, reinforcing our balance sheet strength as we enter the next phase of growth - HZL 2.0."

With continued strength in cost leadership and industry-leading margins, underpinned

by disciplined execution, HZL is well positioned to translate growth opportunities into sustained value creation, he added.

As on March 31, 2026, the company had healthy gross investments and cash and cash equivalents of Rs 13,846 crore invested in high quality debt instruments. Total borrowings outstanding as on March 31, 2026, was Rs 8,252 crore.

The board has approved the first interim dividend of Rs 11 per share for 2026-27 amounting to Rs 4,648 crore.

Hindustan Zinc Ltd is the world's largest integrated zinc producer and is amongst the top five silver producers globally. The company supplies to more than 40 countries and holds a market share of about 77 per cent of the primary zinc market in India.

India and New Zealand to sign free trade agreement on April 27

NEW DELHI: India and New Zealand will sign a free trade agreement (FTA) on April 27 here, Prime Minister Christopher Luxon said on Friday.

The pact aims to provide tariff-free access to the island nation's market for domestic exporters' goods and will bring in \$20 billion in investment over the next 15 years.

"We'll sign our Free Trade Agreement with India on Monday," Luxon said in a social media post. The two countries announced on December 22 last year the conclusion of negotiations for the trade deal,



which aims at doubling bilateral trade to \$5 billion in the next five years.

While India will get zero-duty market access on 100 per cent of its exports, the agreement will eliminate or reduce tariffs on 95 per cent of New Zealand's exports to India,

including items ranging from wool, coal, wood, wine, avocados and blueberries.

However, India has made no duty concessions on imports of dairy products like milk, cream, whey, yoghurt, and cheese; onions, sugar, spices, edible oils, and rubber to protect farmers and the domestic industry. Bilateral merchandise trade stood at \$1.3 billion in FY25. The total trade in goods & services reached about \$2.4 billion in 2024, with services trade alone reaching \$1.24 billion, led by travel, IT & business services.

Sebi allows net settlement of funds for foreign investors

The framework will be implemented on or before December 31, 2026, the Sebi said in its circular

NEW DELHI: Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Friday allowed Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) to net funds for same-day cash market trades, replacing the current gross settlement system, in a move aimed at improving operational efficiency and lowering funding costs—especially during index rebalancing days.

The new framework will be implemented by December 31, 2026, the Sebi said in its circular.

It will enable FPIs to use proceeds from same-day sales to fund purchases, thereby meet-



ing only their net fund obligation. At present, FPIs settle each transaction separately on a gross basis with custodians, leading to higher liquidity requirements, funding costs and foreign exchange slippages.

CLOSER LOOK

- » The new framework will enable FPIs to use proceeds from same-day sales to fund purchases, thereby meeting only their net fund obligation
- » At present, FPIs settle each transaction separately on gross basis with custodians, leading to higher liquidity requirements, funding costs and forex slippages

Sebi said net settlement will apply only to "outright transactions", defined as either a purchase or a sale in a security within a settlement cycle, but not both. Transactions involving both buying and selling in

the same security during a cycle will be excluded and will continue to be settled on a gross basis.

Under the framework, if the value of outright purchases exceeds sales, the FPI will fund

the balance along with any non-outright purchase obligations. However, if sales exceed purchases, the surplus cannot be used to offset non-outright obligations.

The regulator clarified that while fund settlement can be netted, settlement of securities will continue on a gross basis between foreign portfolio investors and custodians. Levies such as Securities Transaction Tax and stamp duty will remain unchanged and be applied on a delivery basis. The move follows Sebi board approval granted last month.

RCB heave a Sai of relief

Kohli, Padikkal explode against GT as Sudharsan's ton goes in vain

BENGALURU: Devdutt Padikkal and Virat Kohli played quintessential T20 knocks of 55 and 81 respectively, trumping Sai Sudharsan's century to power Royal Challengers Bengaluru to a five-wicket win over Gujarat Titans in an IPL match here on Friday.

Once Devdutt and Kohli added 115 runs for the second wicket in no time, RCB's chase of 206 was right on track, which they eventually completed in 18.5 overs and moved to the second spot in the points table (10 points). The champion batter and his understudy tore apart GT bowlers after the early dismissal of Jacob Bethell in a mesmerising display of aggressive batting, in total contrast to the measured way their rivals' went about gathering runs in the first innings.

Kohli, who was dropped on zero by Washington Sundar off Mohammad Siraj, measured the bounce of the pitch to a nicety, tackling Prasidh Krishna and Kagiso Rabada with ease.

Prasidh was carted for two fours, Rabada was flicked away for a six and Rashid Khan, his eternal nemesis, was pulled over mid-wicket for a six as Kohli reigned Chinnaswamy, reaching his fifty in 30 balls.

At the other end, Devdutt



Royal Challengers Bengaluru's Devdutt Padikkal celebrates his half century with Virat Kohli

PTI

was equally imperial, biffing Karnataka statemate Prasidh for a couple of sixes and Rashid too was dispatched for a maximum, fetching his fifty in 10 balls fewer than his senior.

It took a peach from Rashid to castle Devdutt, and Kohli, who till then read the bounce to perfection, ironically dragged a Jason Holder lifter on to his stumps.

It pushed RCB to a wobbly period as they lost skipper Rajat Patidar and Jitesh Sharma as well, slipping to 173 for five.

But Krunal Pandya (23, 12b) and Tim David (10) carried them past the target from that point, as RCB signed off from their home venue with a victory. This was their fourth win at Chinnaswamy from five engagements this season.

Earlier, Sudharsan produced a magnificent 100 that was an anti-thesis of T20 batting, but still strong enough to carry Gujarat to a competitive 205 for three.

In fact, the first 12.4 overs of the Titans' innings was an anti-

thesis of T20 batting, where the former champions proved that runs can be made in this format without hitting the ball in anger. Sudharsan's 58-ball knock, his third hundred in the IPL, was the cornerstone in GT's trend-defying effort with the bat.

The left-hander totally dominated the 128-run alliance with his opening partner and captain Shubman Gill (32, 24b). Sudharsan consumed 29 balls in the Power Play segment against the latter's seven. AGENCIES

Kumble and Bhajji hail Samson

CHENNAI: Spin legends Anil Kumble and Harbhajan Singh hailed Sanju Samson's hundred against Mumbai Indians here as one of the finest in terms of game awareness and context, as Chennai Super Kings returned to winning ways.

"CSK's success has often been built on strong starts from their openers, and in the last few seasons, that hasn't been consistent. Sanju Samson has stepped up in that context, two unbeaten hundreds in just seven matches, and has been instrumental in carrying the team through," Kumble said.

Harbhajan said: "Samson stood out because of his game awareness. A lot of players have talent, but very few understand how to pace an innings in different situations. He recognised the importance of batting till the end." AGENCIES

DC HAVE 3 WINS & 3 LOSSES SO FAR

Delhi Capitals face uphill task against unbeaten Punjab Kings

BENGALURU: Delhi Capitals will have to play out of their skins to get their stuttering campaign back on track when they face high-flying Punjab Kings in the Indian Premier League here on Saturday.

It will be a daunting task for the struggling Delhi outfit -- smarting from a comprehensive 47-run defeat to Sunrisers Hyderabad -- to stand up to a Punjab side that has been firing on all cylinders this season.

With three wins and as many losses from six matches, the Capitals find themselves pushed down the bottom half of the table in sixth place.

In contrast, Punjab Kings remain the only unbeaten team in the competition so far, sitting pretty at the top of the standings with 11 points from six outings. The sole point they lost was due to their game being washed out against Kolkata Knight Riders at Eden Gardens.

Delhi's biggest concern has been their inconsistent batting. While the likes of KL Rahul, David Miller, Tristan Stubbs and Sameer Rizvi have all contributed in patches, the unit has failed to click collectively.

Opener Patum Nissanka, despite getting starts, has been unable to convert them into substantial scores, leaving the middle order with too much



Punjab Kings' Shreyas Iyer will look to make bowlers' life difficult

FILE

'No panic over DC batting'

HYDERABAD: L Delhi Capitals batter Tristan Stubbs downplayed concerns around the team's batting, saying their performances have appeared "worse" largely because they have been chasing in every match this season but admitted they are yet to produce a "perfect" innings. All three defeats have come while pursuing targets in excess of 200, exposing their vulnerability in high-pressure chases. DC failed to cross the 200-run mark in two of those, losing to Chennai Super Kings by 23 runs and Sunrisers Hyderabad by 47 runs. "It has seemed worse because we have been chasing every game. The other day, we lost three wickets in an over and we didn't bat very well. We still made 190 something," Stubbs said at the pre-match presser. AGENCIES

to do. Captain Axar Patel, too, would want to shoulder greater responsibility with the bat. The all-rounder is also under scrutiny for some questionable tactical calls in the previous game. Against a rampaging

Abhishek Sharma, Axar persisted with part-time off-spinner Nitish Rana, who proved ineffective, while frontline options such as himself and Kuldeep Yadav were not utilised enough. AGENCIES

Akshay fires 64 to end title drought

NUH: Akshay Sharma carded an error-free eight-under 64 to claim his third DP World PGTI title, winning by a slender one-shot margin with an aggregate of 19-under 269 here on Friday.

The victory marked Akshay's first title in over five years, since his last

win at Panchkula Golf Club in November 2020, capping a period of consistent performances.

The 35-year-old Chandigarh-based golfer (70-65-70-64) earned Rs 15 lakh as prize money that lifted him to fifth on the PGTI Order of Merit with season earnings of

Rs 37,12,575. Overnight leader Dhruv Sheoran (69-66-66-69) finished runner-up at 18-under 270 after starting the final round with a three-shot advantage. "I've had a lot of consistent finishes recently, so it feels great to finally get the win," Akshay said. MPOST

Thomas & Uber Cup: Men open with a bang against Canada, women held by Denmark

HORSENS: Lakshya Sen endured a tough loss but Ayush Shetty and the doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty registered wins as 2022 champions India notched up a commanding 4-1 win over Canada in their opening Group A tie of the Thomas Cup Finals, here Friday.

After Lakshya's spirited effort ended in a 18-21, 21-19, 21-10 loss to world No. 13 Victor Lai, world No. 4 Satwik and Chirag levelled the tie with a dominant 21-10 21-11 win over Jonathan Bing Tsan Lai and Kevin Lee.

The 20-year-old Ayush, runner-up at the recent Asia Championships, then outwitted world No. 33 Brian Yang 21-13, 21-17 in 39 minutes to hand India a 2-1 lead.

The second doubles pair of Hariharan Amsakarunan and M R Arjun sealed the tie for India with a convincing 21-7 21-15 victory over Ty Alexander Lindeman and Nyl Yakura.

Kidambi Srikanth then outsmarted world No. 77 Joshua Nguyen 21-17 21-12 in the inconsequential fifth match as India wrapped up the match 4-1 to be placed second in the



Satwiksairaj Rankireddy seemed to be having fun on Day 1

BWF

Defending champions China, beat Australia 5-0

table behind China.

China, 11-time winners and defending champions, beat Australia 5-0.

The top two teams from each of the four groups will qualify for the quarter-finals.

"Really happy with the way we played today... although we were

down 0-1, we're happy that we could get a point for the team and make it 1-0. We don't want to keep so many expectations, we just want to enjoy as much as possible," Satwik said.

In the Uber Cup, India were tied 1-1 with hosts Denmark after two matches of their opening tie of Group A. PV Sindhu put India ahead with a tough 21-13 18-21 21-17 win over Denmark's world No. 21 Line Christophersen. World No. 3 Unnati Hooda produced a late fightback and saved multiple match points before going down 12-21 23-25 against Line Hojmark Kjaersfeldt. AGENCIES

India interested in 2038 Asiad

NEW DELHI: India has officially submitted its expression of interest to host the 2038 Asian Games, a top official of the national Olympic body said, marking a significant step in the country's broader strategy to become a global hub for major multi-sporting events.

The Indian Olympic Asso-

ciation (IOA) has recently submitted its Expression of Interest (EOI) to host the 2038 Games to the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA). The continental Olympic body discussed India's EOI at its executive board meeting on April 21 in the Chinese city of Sanya, where the Asian Beach Games began from April 22. AGENCIES

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
(Mechanical Department)
OPEN TENDER NOTICE
NO. RS-101-Underslung-DNR
The Divisional Railway Manager, E. C. Railway, Danapur is inviting online open tender (on IREPS Portal) for and on behalf of the President of India from reputed contractor with experience, financial capability including those registered /working with Railway/Irrigation/CPWD/ MES or any other public sector undertaking for under mentioned works:-
1. Name of work with its location: Repair and Maintenance activities of under slung and onboard equipments of Vanade Bharat/Namo Bharat rakes at RNCC under Danapur division for two year., Location:- RNCC Depot. 2. Approx Cost of the work : Rs. 2,17,67,184/- (Rs. Two Crore Seventeen Lakhs sixteen Thousand one Hundred eighty Four Only). 3. Earnest Money to be deposited : Rs. 4,35,400/- (Four Lakhs thirty five thousand four hundred only). 4. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of tender: Date & time for submission of tender 13.05.2026 up to 12:00 hrs. on www.ireps.gov.in. Date & time of opening of tender-13.05.2026 at 12:30 hrs. on www.ireps.gov.in. 5. Website particulars & Notice Board location where complete details of tender, corrigendum (if any) can be seen etc.: The tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. Divisional Railway Manager (Mech.), E.C. Railway, Danapur PR/0117/DNR/MECH/T/26-27/44

MANIPUR STATE POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY LIMITED
(Secure Office Complex, 3rd Floor, North AOC, Imphal West, - 795001)
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Imphal, the 22nd April, 2026
No.2/02(Civ-Gdn-Store)/2026-MSPDCL-TECH/220426/01-07: Manipur State Power Distribution Company Limited (MSPDCL) a Government of Manipur enterprise invites Sealed Tender from electrical license contractor/Firms for the below work:
TS No. 02/02/2026 - "Construction of New Godown for old Prepaid Energy Meters at store Division, Yurembam, MSPDCL"
The tender details and documents shall be available on payment of cost of tender of Rs. 500/- (non-refundable) from 23/04/2026 to 07/05/2026 at the office of the General Manager (Purchase), MSPDCL, Secure Office Complex, 3rd Floor, North AOC, Imphal-West.
Last date of Submission of Tender: 07/05/2026 (upto 11.00 A.M.)
Date of Opening: 07/05/2026 (Time: 2:00 P.M.)
Venue: MSPDCL Conference Hall
Sd/-
(I. Saratchandra Singh)
General Manager (Purchase), MSPDCL
6/24/2024 DIPR (PI-1)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Name of work and its location:- 76-SRDEE-G-DL-2026-27 Electrical work in connection with "Removing, Commissioning and other associated works of Pumps over Delhi Division".
Approx cost of the works in :- Rs. 9887080.00/-
Address of the office :- Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
Earnest Money:- Rs. 197800.00/-
Last date of time of submission of tender :- 15.05.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender :- 15.05.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board :- www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi. 1364/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Taj Mohammad, S/o Shaid Ali, R/o Village Mandoli, Delhi near Badi Masjid Harsh Vihar, North East, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **Cr. Case No. 2768/21, U/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Taj Mohammad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Taj Mohammad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Taj Mohammad** accused of **Cr. Case No. 2768/21, U/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.09.2026**.
By Order - **Sh. P. Bhargav Rao**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
East District, Room No. 03
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/5331/ED/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer, Northern Railway, Trainset Depot, Shakurbasti, for and on behalf of President of India, invites IREPS (www.ireps.gov.in) for the under noted work.
Tender No. 258965TSDSSB
Name of Work Provision for Outsourcing Selected SS-1 Maintenance Activities for Vande Bharat Rakes for a Period of Three Years.
Approximate Cost Rs.8,68,37,838.88 including GST
Earnest Money Rs.17,36,800.00/-
Completion Period of the work 36 Months
Date and time for opening of tender 14.05.2026 at 14:30
Website particulars notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen Above tender is available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in w.e.f. 22.04.2026, 15:11 hrs.
No. 25.8.965.TSD.SSB Date: 23.04.2026 1365/2026
Serving Customers With A Smile

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur (C.G.) - 492006
CIN : U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN : AABCM6288N, GST Regn No. 22AABCM6288N5ZY
Phone : 0771-6621000 Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (2nd Call)
(e-Procurement Portal)
No.: 01/CSIDC/E.E./Div-IV/2026-27/System No. 189609 Raipur, Dated 23/04/2026
Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender in "Form-A" (Percentage Rate Basis) for the following works:-
S. No. Name of Work Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't. Time allowed including rainy season P.A.C. (INR Lac) EMD (INR Rs.) Cost of Tender Doc. (INR) including GST 18%
1 Construction of District Trade and Industries Centre at Soni, Balod District-Balod (C.G.) B & Above 09 Months i/c Rainy Season 231.35 Lacs 1,16,000/- 3540/-
The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of work and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 23/04/2026 and Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.
NOTE:- The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG eProc Helpdesk. Operated by Mjunction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18002582502 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.cproo@cgswan.gov.in.
samvad 47622/3 Executive Engineer, Division-IV
कार्यालय एवं दुकान हेतु स्थान उपलब्ध, वेबसाईट देखें www.csidc.in

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, लातेहार
अल्पकालीन ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई-निविदा संख्या :- 05/R1/2024-25/EE/RWD/LATEHAR दिनांक : 23.04.2026
क्र० आईडेंटि फिकेशन सं०/पैकेज सं० प्रखंड कार्य का नाम प्राक्कलित राशि (रुपये में) कार्य समाप्ति की तिथि टेंडर कॉल
अंक में अक्षर में
2 RWD/LATE HAR21/2024 -25 बरवाडीह ग्राम पंचायत छँचा पंचायत भवन पी०डब्ल्यूडी० रोड से आंगनबाडी होते हुए कोयल नदी तक ग्थ निर्माण। 342.804 रु० तीन करोड़ बेयालीस लाख अस्सी हजार चार सौ रुपये मात्र। 15 माह द्वितीय
1. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि : 29.04.2026
2. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय : 09.05.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।
3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : 11.05.2026 अपराह्न 03:30 बजे।
4. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता, कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, लातेहार पिन - 829206
5. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० - 06565245038
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है। कार्यपालक अभियन्ता ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग कार्य प्रमण्डल, लातेहार
PR 378352 REO(26-27).D

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(SUCCESSION CASE)
IN THE COURT OF Sh.Rajeev Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) Hisar
Sunil Kumar S/o Late Mahender Singh R/o H.no. 690-A, Professor Colony Balsamand Hisar Vs.
1. General Public /Relatives
2. Neeru D/o Late Mahender Singh and W/o Shiv Kumar R/o H.no. 690-B, Professor Colony Balsamand Hisar
3. Suman Devi D/o Late Mahender Singh and w/o Shri Pal R/o H.no. 65, Vill. Kharkhara Chhajjan Pana, PS Meham Distt Rohtak
Petition for issuances of Succession certificate under Section 372 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925 in respect of estates left by the deceased Mahender Singh aka Mahender Singh who retired as Mate from the O/o Deputy Estate Officer, CCS HAU Hisar Tehsil and Distt Hisar
CNR No. HRH502-000374-2026
Next Date:-07-Oct-2026
NOTICE TO: GENERAL PUBLIC /RELATIVES
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **07-07-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details logon to <https://highcourthd.gov.in/7mod> = district notice & district = Hisar
Sd/- Sh. Rajeev Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) dated 23.04.2026 Hisar

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Invitation for Tenders through E-procurement system
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
1.	09263060	PU BASED GENTIAN BLUE (TWO PACK)	141882 LTR	18.05.26
2.	12261201	PVC INSULATED COPPER CABLE	39588 MTR	18.05.26
3.	08261253	AUTO BATTERY CHARGER	104 NOS	18.05.26
4.	02260052	BLOWER MOTOR 1.1 KW (1.5 HP) 3 PHASE	1013 NOS	25.05.26
5.	77269040	6AMAM THICK NYLON CORD GRSP	1825 SET	29.05.26
	RGC			

Note:-1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice NO. 06/2026-2027 Dt. 24.04.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UJVNL LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O. "UJWALA", MAHARAJGIRI, GATE NO. 10, DEHRADUN-248005, U.P. No. 10/19/2025/1502/2596.
Tele.: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508, website: www.ujvnl.com

No. 338
CORRIGENDUM
Date: 24.04.2026

In reference to NIT No. 02/EE(G)/TPH/2026-27 invited by the office of the Executive Engineer (Generation) Tiloth Power House, Uttarkashi, Section-1 Instructions to tenderers and eligibility criteria Clause 30b, the cost of downloaded tender documents fee shall be ₹590.00 instead of ₹1180.00 Other terms & condition will remain same.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com".
Executive Engineer (Generation)
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB, Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number:U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
(Phone No. 0181-275289) E-mail: se-hq-gssstp-ropar@pspcl.in
E-Tender Enquiry No.7798/P-3/EMP-13299
Dated: 20.04.2026

Dy. Chief Engineer / Headquarter (Purchase Cell-3) GGSSTP, Rupnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_166698_1 for Procurement of friction less Impact Cushion pads for 1500mm wide conveyor belt. For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 22.04.2026 onwards.
Note: - Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
RTP-46/26
PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2026-27/10882

Govt. of Jharkhand Energy Department
Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA)
3rd Floor, S.L.D.C. Building, Kusai Colony, Doranda, Ranchi-834002, Ph.: 0651-2491161, Fax: 0651-2491165, E-mail: info@jreda.com; Website: www.jreda.com

e-Procurement Notice
Tender Reference No.: 09/JREDA/SPV/SHWS/26-27
Dated: 24.04.2026

1	Name of the work	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Agencies for Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Solar Hot Water System (SHWS) Including 5 Year CMC in the State of Jharkhand
2	Period of contract	12 (Twelve) Months
3	Time of completion	03 (Three) Months
4	Date of publication of NIT on website: http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in	30.04.2026 (Thursday)
5	Last date & time for receipt of online bids	25.05.2026 (Monday) upto 05:00 PM
6	Submission of original copies of Bid fee &EMD through Online via SBI Payment Gateway of Jharkhand Tenders	25.05.2026 (Monday) upto 05:00 PM
7	Technical Bid Opening Date	28.05.2026 (Thursday) at 3.00 P.M.
8	Name & address of office inviting tender	Director, Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency(JREDA) 3 rd Floor, SLDC Building, Kusai, Doranda, Ranchi- 834002 (Jharkhand)
9	Contact no. of procurement officer	0651-2491163/61/7004806449
10	Helpline no. of e-procurement	0651-2491163/61

Any corrigendum/addendum can be seen on website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com. Further details can be seen on website: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> & www.jreda.com

PR_NO.378397 Energy(26-27):D
Sd/- Director JREDA, Ranchi

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work:

Name of work	Provision of permanent civil structure (brick and concrete work) with fire rating of 02 hours in place of porta cabin for control panel rooms of escalators installed 21 Nos. at stations (i.e. DEE, GZB, NDLS, NZM, MTC, SNR) in Delhi Division.
Approx cost of work	Rs. 33,13,956.55/- (Rupees Three Crore Thirty Lakh Thirteen Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Six and Fifty Five Paise Only)
Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 6,60,300.00/- (Rupees Six Lakh Sixty Thousand Three Hundred Only)
Cost of tender document	Rs. 0.00/-
Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	15.05.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

* The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. * For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. * No manual offers are acceptable. * Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/10/2026-27/W-3
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE
1356/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Imran S/o Md. Aslam R/o:** X-3166, Gali No.-4, Raghuraj Pura No.-2, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 295/2022, U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Welcome, North-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Imran** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Imran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Imran** the said accused of **FIR No. 295/2022, U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Welcome, North-East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
DP/5377/NE/2026
(Court Matter)
Room No.-19, 1st Floor, Shahdara Distt., Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No: AGC/TRD/T/2026/06
E-Tendering Notice
Date: 22/04/2026

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No.:	AGCTRTD202606	Period of completion:	24 months
Name of work:	Maintenance, Repair & Overhauling of components apart from diesel engine of 4 W and 8 W Tower Wagon of Agra division of NC Railway for a period of 24 months	Approximate Cost:	₹ 2,38,58,670.84
		Earnest Moeny:	₹ 4,77,200/-

(1) For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in. (2) Tender can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 Hrs. on date 15.05.2026. 889/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi- 110005

PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
[See proviso to Rule 8(6)]
[Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)]
E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder:

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price/ Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Shrey Jain (Applicant) Atul Jain (Co Applicant) Lan No. TBPNP00006849628	Puid No 3f6eyf8h, Property Situated At Ward No 19, Abadi Uttam Nagar Gohana Within Limits of M.C. Gohana Tehsil Gohana District Sonapat Haryana (Admeasuring An Area of 319 Sq Yard	Rs. 59,17,460/- As on April 15, 2026	Rs. 53,10,000/- Rs. 5,31,000/-	May 06, 2026 From 01:00 PM To 02:00 PM	May 19, 2026 From 11:00 AM To 12:00 Noon

The online auction will be conducted on the website (URL Link-<https://disposalhub.com>). of our auction agency Ms NexXen Solutions Private Limited. The Mortgage(s)/ Notice(s) are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest by May 18, 2026 before 05:00 P.M else the secured asset(s) will be sold as per schedule. The prospective bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 on or before May 18, 2026 before 05:00 P.M along with the scanned image of the Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. In case the prospective bidder(s) is/ are unable to submit his/ her/ their offer through the website, then the signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, 3rd Floor Shal Tower, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005 on or before May 18, 2026 before 05:00 P.M. Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/ Scheduled Bank in favour of 'ICICI Bank Limited' payable at Delhi. For any further clarifications in terms of inspection, Terms and Conditions of the E-Auction or submission of tenders, contact ICICI Bank Employee Phone No. 8928935040/ 8584874809. Please note that Marketing agencies 1. Ms NexXen Solutions Private Limited, 2. Augeo Assets Management Private Limited 3. Matex Net Pvt. Ltd. 4. Finvin Estate Deal Technologies Pvt Ltd 5. Ginnarsoft Pvt Ltd 6. Hecta Prop Tech Pvt Ltd 7. Arca Emt Pvt Ltd 8. Novel Asset Service Pvt Ltd 9. Nobroker Technologies Solutions Pvt Ltd 10. value trust capital services private limited 11. Navodayan Proptech Private Limited (XpertARC™), have also been engaged for facilitating the sale of this property. The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed Terms and Conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n/4p45.
Date : April 25, 2026
Place: Delhi
Authorized Officer
ICICI Bank Limited

ICICI Bank
Branch office: ICICI Bank Ltd., BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091
CIN No: L65190G11994PLC021012. www.icicibank.com

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice. Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	(Borrower) Ak Enterprises (Guarantor) Sweta Gupta & Anil Kumar & Surendra Kumar & (Mortgagor) Surendra Kumar/ Represented By Partners Anil Kumar & Sweta Gupta Awasthighat Digha, Danapur Cantt Bihar Patna- 801503/ 625905051118	Khata No.18, Khosra No.51, Mauza Awasthi Ghat, Danapur, Pargana Phulwari, Touzi No 5401, Ward No 3, Mahal No.2, Holding No.31, Hal Holding No 37 (Part), Thana No.21, Thana & Sub Registry Danapur Sadar, Sadar Registry & District Patna, Bihar. Owned By Surendra Kumar. (Admeasuring An Area of 1 Katha 5 Dhur 13 Dhurki North: Smt Lila Devi & Smt Siya Dulari Devi South: Nij Lekhyakari Hal Shri Nagendra Kumar Aaj Kharihar Imroja East: Smt Siya Dulari Devi & Ambika Pandit & Ganesh Pandit West: Road/ Date of Symbolic : 22/04/2026	30/12/2025 Rs. 82,46,493.81/-	Patna/ Noida/ Mumbai

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date: April 25, 2026 Place: Noida
Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

Government of Jharkhand
Urban Development and Housing Department
Dhanbad Municipal Corporation, Dhanbad

e-Procurement Re Tender Notice No. DMC/05/2026-27
NIT No.- DMC/05/2026-27
Date :- 24.04.2026

1.	Name of the work	Rejuvenation of Ranibandh Talab Under DMC, Dhanbad.
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs. 4,16,37,000.00
3.	Tender Fee and Bid Security	Tender document fee :- INR 10,000/- (Ten Thousand Only) Non-Refundable. Bid Security: Rs 4163700.00 (Rupees Four Lakh Sixteen Thousand Three Hundred & Seventy Only).
4.	Time of Completion	330 Days
5.	Date / Time of Publication of Tender on Website	02.05.2026 at 03:00 PM
6.	Start Date of Submission of Bids	21.05.2026 at 03:00 PM
7.	Last Date / Time for receipt of bids Online	21.05.2026 (On line) till 03:00 PM
8.	Date and Time of Technical Bid Opening Online.	22.05.2026 (On line) from 03:00 PM
9.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	Chief Executive Officer, Dhanbad Municipal corporation,Dhanbad.
10.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	8986892064
11.	e-mail id	Dhanbadmunicipal corporationadm@gmail.com

NOTE:- (i) Only e-Tenders will be accepted. Further details can be seen on website <http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in>.
(ii) Contractor should be registered in Class (I) First class as per NIT
(iii) Estimated Cost / Quantity May Vary
(iv) Any Change/Information can be seen on Website on <http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in>.
Executive Engineer,
Dhanbad Municipal Corporation, Dhanbad
PR 378343 Urban Development and Housing (26-27)_D

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
MINOR IRRIGATION DESIGN DIVISION,
DUMKA, CAMP-DEOGHAR

e-Procurement Tender Notice
Two Envelope System
Tender Reference No. :- WRD/M.I.D.D.D.C/DEOGHAR/ B.D./S.L.I-02/2026-27 Dt.-24.04.2026

1.	Name of the work	Construction of Chief Minister Solar Based Lift Irrigation Scheme at Pahariya (Poorv) under Block-Sarwan, District-Deoghar.
2.	Estimated Cost (in Rs.)	Rs. 1,52,37,074.95
3.	Cost of Tender Document (in Rs.)	Rs. 10,000.00 only (non-refundable)
4.	Earnest Money Deposit (in Rs.)	Rs. 1,53,000.00 only
5.	Time of Completion	11 Months
6.	Mode of Submission of Tender	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
7.	Date of Publication of Tender on website (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	Date: 29.04.2026, 11:00 A.M.
8.	Last Date/ Time for downloading of bidding documents and submission of Tender on Website	Date: 14.05.2026, 05:00 P.M.
9.	Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	Start Date: 29.04.2026, 11:00 A.M. Last Date: 14.05.2026, 05:00 P.M.
10.	Technical Bid Opening Date	Date: 15.05.2026, 05:00 P.M.
11.	Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Design Division, Dumka, Camp-Deoghar.
12.	Contact No. of Procurement Officer email of Procurement Officer	Mob. No.-7257990512 Email ideemddum-cemdh-jhr@gnic.in
13.	Help line No. of Procurement Cell	Mob. No.-7004677611

➤ **Note :- Estimated cost may increase or decrease.**
➤ Work will be awarded to those bidders (specially MNRE approved channel partners/MNRE approved manufacturers/ MNRE approved PV system integrators/ A registered manufacturers/ Company/ Firm/ Corporation in India (including MSME of Jharkhand) or at least one of the major sub system namely pumps or PV System electronics (confirming to National/ International Standards) or any other agencies having experience of installation and commissioning of such solar powered irrigation schemes). Empanelled Indigenous Manufacturers of 10 HP pumps (AC Surface water Pumps) in the department with all accessories for off-grid stand alone SPV water pumping systems can also take part in the bid for executing the whole work of the bid. However those bidders who have not yet registered in Water Resources Department can also submit their bid provided they will have to get themselves registered in Water Resources Department within two months from the date of allotment of work.
➤ Only e-Tender will be accepted.
➤ Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>.

Executive Engineer
Minor Irrigation Design Division ,
Dumka, Camp-Deoghar

SHRI LAL BHADUR SHASTRI NATIONAL
SANSKRIT UNIVERSITY
(Central University)
B-4, Qutab Institutional Area, New Delhi-110016

The University invites online applications for regular recruitment to various categories of non-teaching positions. For details, please visit the University website <https://www.slbsrsv.ac.in>.
The last date for receipt of online application is **21.05.2026**.
Sd/-
Registrar
Cbc 21371/11/0001/2627

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person Namely **Sonu S/o Amarnath R/o Vill.Chanchal Nursing Home, Agar Nagar, Prem Nagar-III, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 447/2013 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act.**, has been registered at **PS. Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Sonu** of under **FIR No. 447/2013 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act.**, registered at **PS. Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.05.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Apoorav Bhardwaj
JMFC (North West), Room No. 113
1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Arjun, S/o. Pirwat, R/o.: H. No.: 252, Kotla Village, Mayur Vihar Phase-I, East Delhi-110091** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.539/2022 U/S 279/304A & 3/180, 3/181 M.V ACT** registered at **P.S Kalyan Puri, East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Arjun** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Arjun** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arjun**, accused of **FIR No.539/2022 U/S 279/304A & 3/180, 3/181 M.V ACT, P.S Kalyan Puri, East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.
DP/5359/ED/2026
(Court Matter)
By Order, Prigya Gupta
Chief Judicial Magistrate, East District,
Court No. 29, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER GENERATION CO. LTD.
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
No. 03-03/ TN-31/26-27/236
Raipur. Dtd 23/04/2026
E-TENDER NOTICE NO. TN-31/26-27

Online bids are invited for Supply/ work as mentioned below:-

S. No.	Tender no. /RFX no.	Description	Submission Date & time
1.	CP-39/26-27 8100050987 (With RLA)	Procurement of High Pressure Boiler Tubes for ABVTSP, Marwa	14.05.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs

For details please visit our website https://cspc.co.in/pspgcl_tendernotices/ or our e-bidding portal:- <https://ebidding.cspc.co.in:50724/irj/portal>
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR(S&P:GEN)
SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 47630/1 CSPGCL-RAIPUR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Ajeet Shrivastav S/o Ramesh Chand R/o: A-284 Harsh Vihar-2, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 2058/2019, U/S: 138 NI ACT, PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Ajeet Shrivastav**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Ajeet Shrivastav**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Ajeet Shrivastav**, of **CC No. 2058/2019, U/S: 138 NI ACT, PS: Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.05.2026**.
By Order
Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 73, 5th Floor, North East District,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Ghanshyam, S/o: Arjun Kumar, R/o: H.No. 268 or 26-B, Ratan Singh Marg, Hemchand Awana Ka Makan, Shree Colony, Meethapur Village, Jaipur, New Delhi, Also At: B-95, Basantpur Colony, Near Phool Singh Ki Kothii, Faridabad, Haryana**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 623/2020, U/s: 380/457/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Jaipur, New Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Ghanshyam**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Ghanshyam**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Ghanshyam**, **FIR No.:623/2020, U/s: 380/457/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Jaipur, New Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.
By Order
Ms Chhavi Bansal, Id.
Judicial Magistrate, First Class
South-East District, Room No.09
Saket Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rihan S/o Sehroz Alam R/o E-49/K-480, Janta Colony, Welcome, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 873/2023 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rihan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rihan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rihan** of case **FIR No. 873/2023 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.05.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 19, 1st Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/5374/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mohd. Umar S/o Mohd. Ezaz R/o C-140, Gali No. 9/3, Kanjia Masjid Wali Gali, Shiv Mandir Marg, Majupur, Jafrabad, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 153/2019 U/s 498-A/406/323/ 506/341/34 IPC, P.S. Jafrabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Umar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd. Umar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Umar** of case **FIR No. 153/2019 U/s 498-A/406/323/ 506/341/34 IPC, P.S. Jafrabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.05.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Nidhi Bala
Judicial Magistrate First Class, Mahila Court-03
Room No. 08, 2nd Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/5041/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Laxmi Narayan Bansal@Bittu, S/o: Rajender Kumar, R/o: F-106/2, F-1144 Shaid Sukhdev Nagar, Wazirpur, Industrial Area, Ashok Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CR Case No. 3853/2020, U/s: 457/380/411/34 IPC, Police Station Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Laxmi Narayan Bansal@Bittu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Laxmi Narayan Bansal@Bittu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Laxmi Narayan Bansal@Bittu** of **Police Station Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.06.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Apoorv Bhardwaj
JMFC-02, North-West, 1st Floor, Room No. 113,
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/5321/RD/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. JHS/Br/L/2026-27/01
E-TENDER NOTICE
(Single Packet System)
Date : 21.04.2026

Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge/Line/Jhansi, North Central Railway, Jhansi for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tenders on the prescribed forms for the under noted

Tender no. :	B:-JHS-2026-01	Approx. Cost of work :	Rs. 6,17,64,836.42/-
Name of work :	Balance work of regirdering of Br. No. 1251/1 DN (3x30.50 M) on GWL-DHO section.		
Bid Security (Earnest Money) :	Rs. 12,35,300.00/-		

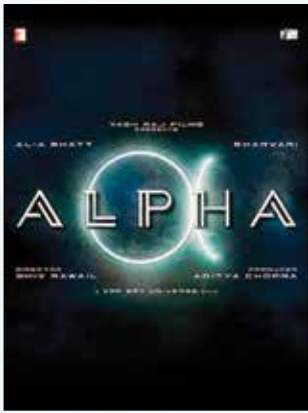


Alia calls ‘Alpha’ a ‘fun film’

Bhatt shared why she’s ‘betting’ on the YRF film after Jigra’s box office slump

Alia Bhatt’s 2024 action-thriller ‘Jigra’ underperformed at the box office, despite high expectations. Even the makers described it as a ‘disappointing’ yet ‘proud’ project. In the past, many other actresses have carried films on their shoulders, including her own film ‘Raazi’ (2018), Rani Mukerji’s ‘Mardaani’, Vidya Balan starrer ‘Kahaani’ and many more. However, in a recent interview, Alia claimed that none of the films from this genre has been accepted in the past. She also opened up about ‘betting’ on her next film ‘Alpha’, which is the first female-led film in the YRF spy universe.

During a chat with ‘Femina’, she was asked about calling her upcoming action-thriller film Alpha a ‘risk’ and giving a nod to the project. “I think what made me say ‘yes’ to it, number one, it’s a genre that I’m passionate about and one that has not been explored in the past, in India at least.



So, I wanted to understand: why has it not been accepted wholeheartedly in the past?” she said.

The actress added, “There have been female action characters within films driven by men, but there’s never been a story that was told where the protagonist is a female character and where the storytelling is engag-

ing you to the point where it doesn’t matter what the gender is.”

Alia further mentioned how female-led films in the action-thriller genre have not worked that well in the past. “I could be com-

pletely wrong, but I believe, deep in my heart, that if the story is powerful and if the story connects, it doesn’t matter who’s leading it or whether

the protagonist is male or female. There have been female-led successful films, but in this particular genre? It’s historically not fully worked,” she reflected.

The second reason to sign YRF’s ‘Alpha’ was its fresh and brilliant story. “And number two, I really liked the story! I thought it was new. It’s something that I hadn’t done as an actor before and I had not seen in recent years. Actually, it’s not just me; it’s Sharvati as well! Two women. Even that was exciting to me. I found a really good vibe with Sharvati. I also wanted to have fun at the movies,” she said.

“Alpha” is actually a popcorn entertainment, a fun film. A very specific genre with storytelling at the heart of it. Once the unit is out and hopefully, the world opens up, you will see a lot of that, there’s something to explore here with women and this genre,” Bhatt concluded.

AGENCIES

She mentioned how female-led films in the action-thriller genre haven’t worked that well in the past

Off-Campus: Locker rooms and late nights

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video’ released the trailer for the upcoming series ‘Off Campus’. Based on the international bestselling book series from Elle Kennedy and created for television by Louisa Levy, all episodes of the series will be available on May 13, 2026. A new version of the book cover, featuring series stars Ella Bright and Belmont Cameli, has also been released.

A college soap based on the bestselling book series, ‘Off Campus’ follows an elite ice hockey team and the women in their lives, as they grapple with love, heartbreak and self-discovery - forging deep friendships and enduring bonds while navigating the complexities that come with transitioning into adulthood. Season one follows the sexy and fun ‘opposites attract’ romance between quiet songwriter, Hannah and Briar University’s all-star hockey athlete, Garrett.

Series regulars of ‘Off Campus’ include Ella Bright (‘The Crown’, ‘Malory Towers’) Belmont Cameli (‘Until Dawn’, ‘Saved by the Bell’), Mika Abdalla (‘Snack Shack’, ‘Sex Appeal’), Antonio Cipriano (‘Pretty Little Liars: Original Sin’, ‘National Treasure: Edge of History’), Jalen Thomas Brooks (‘The Pitt’, ‘Thanksgiving’), Josh Heuston (‘Dune: Prophecy’, ‘Heartbreak High’) and Stephen Kalyn (‘Gen V’, ‘Motorheads’).

Elle Kennedy, the creator of the ‘Off Campus’ universe, is a New York Times, USA Today and Wall Street Journal bestselling author of more than 50 contemporary fiction and romance novels. Her works have been translated into over 25 languages.

Starring Ella Bright, Belmont Cameli and others, the series will stream on May 13



Maggie Gyllenhaal to head Venice Film Festival’s jury

The American actress-director to lead the jury that awards the Golden Lion for ‘Best Film’

American actress-filmmaker Maggie Gyllenhaal will preside over the international competition jury at the 83rd Venice International Film Festival.

Known for her movies such as ‘The Lost Daughter’, ‘The Bride’ and ‘Crazy Heart’, Gyllenhaal will lead the jury that awards the Golden Lion for ‘Best Film’ and other official awards at the film gala, slated to take place from September 2 to 12 this year, the festival announced.

The decision was made by the Board of Directors of La Biennale di Venezia, who confirmed the recommendation of the Director of the Venice Film Festival, Alberto Barbera.

The festival is slated to take place from September 2 to 12 this year



tival,” Barbera added.

“I am thrilled to accept the invitation to lead this year’s Venice Film Festival jury. Venice has always supported truthful, singular voices and I am honoured to play a part in continuing that brave and necessary tradition. I will not be standing in judgment, but in curiosity, admiration and excitement,” Gyllenhaal said.

Barbera said the actress embodies an artistic path of uncommon consistency, constructed over time with intelligence and courage. “An actress who is able to portray disturbing and multifaceted characters, she also reinvented herself as an author with ‘The Lost Daughter’, which won the ‘Best Screenplay’ award here in Venice in 2021. Having her as the president of our jury means being able to rely on an authoritative and independent voice, animated by that authentic passion for arthouse cinema which has always represented the heart of the festival,” Barbera added.

On the closing night of the festival, the jury, chaired by Gyllenhaal and composed of no more than seven international celebrities in the spheres of film and culture from different countries, will award the Golden Lion for ‘Best Film’, Silver Lion - Grand Jury Prize, Silver Lion - Award for ‘Best Director’, Coppa Volpi for ‘Best Actress’, Coppa Volpi for ‘Best Actor’, Special Jury Prize, Award for ‘Best Screenplay’ and Marcello Mastroianni Award for ‘Best New Young Actor or Actress’.

Gyllenhaal, an Academy Award-nominated actress, director, producer and screenwriter, released ‘The Bride’ this year, which she wrote, produced and directed. It is an imaginative continuation of the Frankenstein story.

The actress made her feature directorial debut with her adaptation of Elena Ferrante’s novel ‘The Lost Daughter’, starring Olivia Colman, Dakota Johnson and Jessie Buckley.

PTI

Kajol shares about her past difficulty in bonding with daughter

Nysa is Kajol and Ajay Devgn’s elder child. They also have a son, Yug

Kajol, who opened up about her parenting journey, recently talked candidly about building a strong relationship with her daughter Nysa while navigating the pressures of growing up in the age of social media. Nysa is Kajol and Ajay Devgn’s elder child; they also have a son, Yug.

In a recent conversation with Lilly Singh, Kajol was asked how she deals with the constant influx of information and external pressures that young girls face today and whether her daughter turns to her for guidance. The actress spoke about the ups and downs that shaped their bond over the years.

“I have a lot of talks with her. I talk to her. I talk her through things. It’s a relationship that we had to build. And we built it because of the simple fact that we just... I mean, hormones hit and she was 12. And it was, we were all over the place. We were fighting and we were both irrational at times. We were both illogical at times.”

Recalling how she consciously chose to change her approach as a parent, Kajol added, “I stood up and I said, ‘I’m the adult. I should be a little more rational’. So, I decided that I’m not going to fight with her that much. I’m going to try and talk to her as much as I can. Talk to her till she starts listening to me and work with her. And so, we both struggled for nearly three years. Both of us were like, ‘I don’t listen to you. I don’t want to talk to you’. But eventually, it became long conversations.”

She further shared that the turning point came when she shifted her approach from instructing to listening. “I realised that it was more about just me sitting down and listening to her. It wasn’t about talking so much. It was just about giving her space to talk about herself and to be heard. And that made the biggest difference. Once I realised that it was not about trying to tell her how to do things. She would figure it out on her own. She just needed me to sit there and listen to her as much as I could. So that was my biggest learning as a parent. So, touch wood, we’re okay today.”

AGENCIES



‘Nysa and I were fighting and struggling with each other for three years,’ says the actress

GLOBAL VANGUARD HONOUR PEECEE TO BE HONOURED

Gold Gala 2026 to take place at The Music Centre in downtown Los Angeles

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Hollywood superstar Priyanka Chopra Jonas, along with EJAE and Charles Melton, is set to be honoured at the Gold House Gold Gala 2026, taking place on May 9 at The Music Centre in downtown Los Angeles.

Now in its fifth year, the Gold Gala, widely regarded as a leading celebration of Asian Pacific excellence, is expanding its vision into a broader global platform that recognises cultural influence and impact across industries. This year’s theme, ‘A New Gold World’, reflects a collective effort to build shared progress and opportunity in a time marked by division. The event will bring together over 650 influential leaders to celebrate the ‘Gold 100 List’, with standout honorees including Priyanka Chopra



Jonas, Charles Melton, Jet Li, Simu Liu, Eileen Gu and more, each recognised for their contributions to culture and global storytelling.

Among the key honours, Priyanka Chopra Jonas will receive the prestigious Global Vanguard Honour, acknowledging her remarkable 25-year career that has bridged the Asian Pacific and Western entertainment industries. Her body of work spans acclaimed performances in Hindi cinema and Hollywood, alongside her continued efforts to spotlight emerging and under-

represented talent through her production banner, ‘Purple Pebble Pictures’ an impact that has earned her recognition on platforms such as ‘TIME 100’ and Forbes’ ‘Most Powerful Women’.

The evening will also feature appearances by Gold 100 honorees across diverse sectors, including entertainment, business, technology, fashion, social impact, sports, and gaming. Famous names will take the stage to share their vision for the future.

The evening will also feature appearances by Gold 100 honorees across diverse sectors

